

The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra Called the Dhāraṇī of the Jewel Meteor

Ārya-ratnolkā-nāma-dhāraṇī-mahāyāna-sūtra · Toh 145 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་དཀར་མཆོག་ཏུ་ལ་ལའི་གཟུངས་ཞེས་བ་བྱ་ཐག་པ་ཆེ་པའི་མཛོད་

The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra Called the Dhāraṇī of the Jewel Meteor, known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-ratnolkā-nāma-dhāraṇī-mahāyāna-sūtra and in Tibetan as Phags pa dkon mchog ta la la'i gzungs zhes bya ba theg pa chen po'i mdo, is a Mahāyāna dhāraṇī sūtra centering on a powerful dhāraṇī — a sacred formula for protection and spiritual accomplishment — associated with the image of a radiant jewel meteor. The text opens in the classic sūtra style, with the Buddha dwelling on Vulture Peak at Rājagṛha in the company of a vast assembly of monks and bodhisattvas, establishing the authoritative setting from which the teaching flows. As a dhāraṇī sūtra, it belongs to that genre of Mahāyāna literature in which the recitation and preservation of sacred formulas is presented as a central vehicle for liberation and merit. It is catalogued as Toh 145 in the Kangyur, where it is classified among the general sūtra collections of the Mahāyāna.

In the language of India: Ārya-ratnolkā-nāma-dhāraṇī-mahāyāna-sūtra. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra Called the Dhāraṇī of the Jewel Meteor.

The first fascicle.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling at Rājagṛha on Vulture Peak Mountain together with a great Saṅgha of monks fully one thousand in number — monks who were wholly and perfectly accomplished in virtuous qualities, who roared a great lion's roar, who were solely skilled in seeking the inexhaustible accumulation of primordial wisdom. He was also accompanied by a great Saṅgha of bodhisattvas, namely: the bodhisattva great being Samantabhadra; the bodhisattva great being Precious Mudrā in Hand; the bodhisattva great being Ever Diligent; the bodhisattva great being Adorned with Qualities; the bodhisattva great being Merit Proclaimed; the bodhisattva great being Great Intellect; the bodhisattva great being Array of Qualities; the bodhisattva great being Vajra Intellect; the bodhisattva great being Vajra Essence; the bodhisattva great being Vajra Light; the bodhisattva great being Vajra Weapon; the bodhisattva great being Solid Vajra; the

bodhisattva great being Earth Holder; the bodhisattva great being Dhāraṇī Intellect; the bodhisattva great being Seer of All Aims; the bodhisattva great being Avalokiteśvara; the bodhisattva great being Attained Great Power; the bodhisattva great being Steadfast Intellect; Vajrapāṇi; the bodhisattva great being Mañjuśrī in his youthful form; the bodhisattva great being Dispeller of Lower Rebirths; the bodhisattva great being Vanquisher of All Sorrow and Darkness; the bodhisattva great being Who Overwhelms with Supreme Prowess; the bodhisattva great being Neither Grasping Nor Rejecting; the bodhisattva great being Sandalwood Essence; the bodhisattva great being Ocean of Intellect; the bodhisattva great being Hard to Arise; the bodhisattva great being Source of Joy; the bodhisattva great being Intellect of Conduct; the bodhisattva great being Accumulated Eloquence; the bodhisattva great being Swift Essence; and the bodhisattva great being Maitreya — together with these and many other bodhisattva great beings who abide in inconceivable liberation, who are resolute through the meditative absorption of courageous progress, whose voices are unimpeded, who are skilled in overwhelming innumerable buddha-fields, who abide in fearlessness, who are free from attachment and from anger, who are endowed with a pleasing voice, who are not attached to the three realms, who are accompanied by an inseparable retinue, who are born directly from omniscience, who are endowed with immeasurable meditative absorptions and meditative attainments, who fulfill all hopes, and who have thoroughly penetrated and understood the Perfection of Wisdom.

who are devoted to the meaningful ends of the actions of body, speech, and mind, who strive ardently toward omniscience, whose meditative absorption and conduct are blessed without measure, who have attained fearlessness, whose domain of activity is emptiness, and who abide solely in signlessness — together with all of these.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Samantabhadra, who had gathered in that very assembly, bowed his head to the feet of the Blessed One and addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, how is the dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena, to be understood?"

The Blessed One declared: "Son of good family, the dharmadhātu is to be understood as being without any thing. Son of good family, the dharmadhātu is like space — free from conceptual elaboration, unelaborated, without anything to take up and without anything to cast away, devoid of any thing, and without any fixed abiding. Thus is it to be understood."

Samantabhadra the bodhisattva asked: "Blessed One, what then? Does the dharmadhātu arise?"

The Blessed One declared: "Son of good family, the dharmadhātu does not arise. Son of good family, the dharmadhātu is inconceivable. Son of good family, the dharmadhātu is to be understood as being without any thing — that thing being neither expressible in words in any way whatsoever, nor demonstrable."

Samantabhadra the bodhisattva asked: "Blessed One, does awakening have many aspects?"

The Blessed One declared: "Son of good family, the aspects of awakening are immeasurable, and it is impossible to present it as having a definite measure."

Samantabhadra the bodhisattva asked: "Blessed One, what then? Does the dharmadhātu engage in conceptual thought?"

The Blessed One declared: "Son of good family, the dharmadhātu does not engage in conceptual thought."

Samantabhadra the bodhisattva asked: "Blessed One, if the dharmadhātu is free from conceptual thought, why then do childish ordinary beings engage in thought?"

The Blessed One declared: "Son of good family, all childish ordinary beings arise from thought, conceptual thought, and thorough thought."

Samantabhadra the bodhisattva said: "Blessed One, the awakening of the Tathāgatas is profound."

The Blessed One declared: "Son of good family, it is indeed so — just as you have said. Son of good family, furthermore, the absence of conceptual elaboration in all phenomena is called awakening."

Then the youthful Mañjuśrī, who had gathered in that very assembly, bowed his head to the feet of the Blessed One and addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, may you please teach the dhāraṇī called 'the Jewel Tālā.'"

The Blessed One declared: "Son of good family, ask the bodhisattva Samantabhadra here, who abides in the eloquence that is unobstructed with regard to all phenomena; he will teach it to you."

Then the youthful Mañjuśrī turned to face the Blessed One directly, pressed his palms together with ten fingers joined, and addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Why does the Blessed One himself, who is all-knowing and all-seeing, not teach it?"

The Blessed One declared: "Son of good family, in whatever assembly bodhisattvas endowed with such qualities as these are present, the Tathāgatas abide in equanimity."

Mañjuśrī said: "Blessed One, the Tathāgatas do not abide in equanimity."

The Blessed One declared: "Son of good family, I do not abandon the realm of sentient beings.

"Son of good family, yet the teaching of bodhisattvas is immeasurable and inconceivable."

Then the youthful Mañjuśrī once again addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, I request you to teach the dhāraṇī called Konchok Talala."

The Blessed One declared: "Son of good family, ask the bodhisattva Samantabhadra about this, and he will teach it to you. Why is that? Son of good family, this noble being abides in the accumulation of primordial wisdom."

Mañjuśrī said: "If the Tathāgata would be so gracious, I will ask this noble being."

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, you yourself have attained samādhi as numerous as the finest particles of dust — what need is there to petition the Tathāgata? Son of good family, you are endowed with a share in all the qualities of a buddha."

Mañjuśrī said: "Blessed One, all the qualities of a buddha that I have relied upon, cultivated, and practiced extensively — all of these I understand to be the power of the Tathāgata as the noble being."

The Blessed One declared: "Son of good family, excellent, excellent! You have spoken these words well. And yet, Mañjuśrī, I urge you: ask the bodhisattva Samantabhadra."

Then the youthful Mañjuśrī addressed the Blessed One once more in these words: "Blessed One, this bodhisattva Samantabhadra teaches what is supremely profound; he has fully penetrated the realization of the Great

Vehicle."

The Blessed One declared: "Son of good family, you too are the sovereign king over all phenomena — do not speak this way to me. Moreover, son of good family, you are endowed with inconceivable meditative absorptions abiding in emptiness."

Then the youthful Mañjuśrī pressed his palms together with ten fingers joined, paid homage to the bodhisattva Samantabhadra, and addressed him in these words: "O son of the Victor, if you would grant me this opening, I would ask you just two syllables."

The bodhisattva Samantabhadra replied: "Son of good family, if you know how to bring it to the right moment, then ask."

Then the youthful Mañjuśrī said to the bodhisattva, the great being Samantabhadra: "O son of the Victor, what is the foundational meaning of the word 'buddha, buddha'?"

The bodhisattva Samantabhadra replied: "O son of the Victor, the foundational meaning of 'buddha' is the meaning of having no foundation. The foundational meaning of 'buddha' is the meaning of having no thing. The foundational meaning of 'buddha' is the meaning of being inconceivable. The foundational meaning of 'buddha' is the meaning of being equal to what is unequal. The foundational meaning of 'buddha' is the meaning of being free from conceptual elaboration. The foundational meaning of 'buddha' is the meaning of not having elaborated. The foundational meaning of 'buddha' is the meaning of nothing to be taken up. The foundational meaning of 'buddha' is the meaning of nothing to be cast aside. The foundational meaning of 'buddha' is the meaning of being like space. The foundational meaning of 'buddha' is the meaning of being inexpressible. Son of good family, such is the intrinsic nature of the qualities of a buddha."

Mañjuśrī said: "O son of the Victor, if all phenomena are free from conceptual elaboration, then how was what is called 'the qualities of a buddha' taught?"

The bodhisattva Samantabhadra replied: "O son of the Victor, this teaching is without anything taught."

Mañjuśrī said: "O son of the Victor, if there is nothing taught, what then was taught?"

The bodhisattva Samantabhadra replied:

"O Mañjuśrī, what is without anything taught is taught by way of designation."

Mañjuśrī said: "O son of the Victor, what does designation designate?"

The bodhisattva Samantabhadra replied: "O Mañjuśrī, designation designates neither an existent thing nor a non-existent thing."

Mañjuśrī said: "O son of the Victor, if designation designates neither an existent thing nor a non-existent thing, then how were the three vehicles taught?"

The bodhisattva Samantabhadra replied: "O Mañjuśrī, do not become attached to the dharmadhātu, which is free from attachment. Why? Because the Tathāgata taught that all phenomena are without existence. And why are they without existence? Because the five aggregates have no referential object."

Mañjuśrī said: "Is awakening accompanied by conceptual elaboration, or is it free from conceptual elaboration?"

The bodhisattva Samantabhadra replied: "Son of good family, awakening is neither accompanied by conceptual elaboration nor free from conceptual elaboration. For awakening, conceptual elaboration, and freedom from conceptual elaboration — these are non-dual and indivisible."

Then the Blessed One bestowed upon the bodhisattva, the great being Samantabhadra, this word of praise: "Excellent! Excellent, son of good family, that this inconceivable teaching has been taught." He added: "By the speaking of these words, this world together with its gods will become bewildered."

Mañjuśrī said: "Blessed One, a teaching of Dharma such as this is not fit to be sought in terms of its aspects."

The Blessed One declared: "Son of good family, that is so. It is exactly as you have said."

Then the youthful Mañjuśrī addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, are all phenomena designated by this designation?"

The Blessed One declared: "Son of good family, that is so. It is exactly as you have said."

Then the bodhisattva Samantabhadra addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, this gateway of complete purity is difficult to have faith in."

The Blessed One declared: "Son of good family, that is so. It is exactly as you have said."

Then the bodhisattva Ocean of Intelligence addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, the bodhisattva Samantabhadra has spoken well in teaching this gateway of complete purity."

The Blessed One declared: "Son of good family, that is so. It is exactly as you have said. Moreover, son of good family, this is in harmony with the cause of all phenomena. This is the great rain of Dharma."

Then the brahmin who abides in equanimity, like a great sāla tree, addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, awakening is an equanimity that is inconceivable. Within it, no syllable is observed and no word is observed."

The Blessed One declared: "Son of good family, that is so. Within the dharmadhātu, no word appears, and no meaning appears."

Then the youthful Mañjuśrī addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, what is the cause and condition of emptiness? What is its aspect? What is its sign? What is its characteristic mark?"

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, emptiness is inexpressible and cannot be described. Whatever faith there is in this nature of reality that is beyond expression — that is called emptiness. Emptiness is without syllables; therefore it is called emptiness. Emptiness is indescribable; therefore it is called emptiness. Son of good family, all phenomena are empty by way of their essential nature as phenomena."

Then the venerable Śāradvatīputra addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, behold the magical displays of those bodhisattvas who abide in inconceivable phenomena."

The Blessed One declared: "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, the understanding of a bodhisattva who has just first aroused the awakening mind is supreme, whereas the understanding of an arhat is not so. Why is that? An arhat dwells far from the qualities of a buddha, whereas that bodhisattva is destined to become a fully awakened buddha, a Blessed One."

Then the bodhisattva, the great being, the Sovereign King of All Phenomena addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, as I understand the meaning of what the Blessed One has taught, śrāvakas simply have not attained the qualities of śrāvakas."

The Blessed One declared: "Son of good family, it is not that śrāvakas have not attained the qualities of śrāvakas. Yet where would a śrāvaka find the capacity and power to answer questions together with a bodhisattva, or to consecrate the conduct of others?"

Then Mañjuśrī, the prince of Dharma, addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, if the Tathāgata has declared Śāradvatīputra to be supreme among those endowed with wisdom, to whom has this declaration been made?"

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, this declaration I have made is a declaration of no-declaration."

Then Mañjuśrī, the prince of Dharma, said to the elder Śāradvatīputra: "Elder, have you attained the qualities of a śrāvaka?"

He replied: "That is not so."

Mañjuśrī said: "Then are you an ordinary person?"

He replied: "That is not so."

Mañjuśrī said: "Then are you a learner?"

He replied: "That is not so."

Mañjuśrī said: "Then are you not the supreme one endowed with wisdom?"

He replied: "That is not so."

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, if you are neither an ordinary person, nor a learner, nor the supreme one endowed with wisdom, then you yourself will become one who has an object of observation."

Śāradvatīputra replied: "Son of good family, I do not contend with you — a noble being as unfathomable as the ocean."

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, you are the foremost and eldest in seniority; therefore, venerable Śāradvatīputra, do not speak in such a way."

The elder replied: "Son of good family, nothing is attained and nothing is directly realized by virtue of mere old age. Son of good family, so that you may know this very point, let me offer you an analogy. Son of good family, consider this: even a small vajra can shatter a great mountain of rock. Son of good family, likewise, the wisdom dwelling in a single one of your pores is something that beings like me do not possess even to the number of the finest

atoms. Son of good family, so that you may know this very point, let me offer you another analogy. Son of good family, consider this: even a great and utterly unruly bull elephant can be tamed by a person of strength wielding a small iron hook. Son of good family, likewise, you are one possessed of strength while I am one of little power — how could I possibly contend with one like this great elephant?"

Then the venerable Śāradvatīputra addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, consider this analogy: if a blind man were to follow along after someone, or if he cannot even catch the scent of a city he has sighted — how then could he catch the scent of going from house to house? He has no place to stand. In the same way, before the likes of this great elephant, I see myself as equal to the blind man.

"These qualities of a buddha are so vast and extensive. I am not a vessel fit to hold the qualities of a buddha, and there is nothing at all I can now do."

The Blessed One declared: "Śāradvatīputra, do not say such things. Śāradvatīputra, consider this analogy: all the sentient beings who are touched by the light of a Tathāgata will attain the qualities of a buddha. In the same way, Śāradvatīputra, you yourself have attained meditative absorptions that are boundless and inconceivable."

When the Blessed One had taught this presentation of the Dharma, ninety-two thousand sentient beings from among gods and humans realized the Dharma directly.

Then the bodhisattva Dharmamati entered into meditative equipoise in the bodhisattva samādhi called Endless Application to the Rare and Precious. The very moment the bodhisattva Dharmamati had entered into that equipoise, buddhas, Blessed Ones, appeared before him from a distance beyond as many world-systems of buddha fields as there are atoms in ten thousand buddha fields, in each of the ten directions. Each and every one of those buddhas, those Blessed Ones, shared without exception the name Vajragarbha. And just as it was in one direction, so it was likewise in all ten. Those buddhas, those Blessed Ones, then addressed him with these words:

"Excellent, excellent, Dharmamati! You have well entered into meditative equipoise in the bodhisattva samādhi of Endless Application. Son of good family, it is through the previous aspirational prayers of this very Blessed One, the Tathāgata Vairocana, through his previous blessings, and through the support of your own roots of virtue, that we — Tathāgatas from the ten

directions, all bearing the concordant name, from world-systems as numerous as the atoms in ten thousand buddha fields — now bestow blessings upon you, so that you may: teach all phenomena, purify the wisdom of a buddha, expand the wisdom of a buddha, enter into the dharmadhātu, liberate the expanse of sentient beings, enter into and penetrate the wisdom free of attachment, bring everything into thorough application, express all languages, enter into the wisdom of omniscience, be unobstructed with respect to all phenomena, and enter into the teaching of the Dharma that fully knows all three times. Therefore, son of good family, generate confidence in this teaching of the Dharma — beginning from the ten stations of a bodhisattva — through the power of the buddhas and the blessing of the buddhas."

Then those buddhas, those Blessed Ones, bestowed upon the bodhisattva Dharmamati the luminosity of unobstructed wisdom, and caused him to accomplish the beautiful expression of: freedom from obscurations, freedom from interruption, freedom from forgetfulness, the nature of reality that is non-differentiated, undivided wisdom, blamelessness, invincibility, freedom from discouragement, and the nature of reality that is free from theft.

Why so? Because it is through having attained the nature of reality of this very samādhi.

Then those buddhas, those Blessed Ones, extended their right hands and stroked the head of the bodhisattva Dharmamati. The very moment those buddhas, those Blessed Ones, had touched the bodhisattva Dharmamati, he arose from that samādhi and addressed those bodhisattvas:

"O sons of the Victors! The lineage of bodhisattvas is such that —"

it extends as far as the dharmadhātu reaches and touches the bounds of the expanse of space.

O sons of the Victors! In this way, bodhisattvas, great beings, are born into the lineage of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, of the past; they are born into the lineage of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, of the future; and they are born into the lineage of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, of the present.

Then those bodhisattvas said this to the bodhisattva Dharmamati: "O son of the Victors, who are these bodhisattvas, these great beings, who are born into the lineage of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, of the past, the future, and the present? On what basis do you speak thus? O sons of the Victors, tell us what those ten modes of establishing bodhisattvas as bodhisattvas are."

When they had spoken thus, the bodhisattva Dharmamati said to those bodhisattvas: "O sons of the Victors, the ten modes of establishing bodhisattvas as bodhisattvas are these. They were declared, they are declared, and they will be declared by the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, of the past, the future, and the present. What are the ten? They are as follows: the mode of establishing the bodhisattva who has first aroused the mind; the mode of establishing the beginner; the mode of establishing one who practices yoga; the mode of establishing one who is reborn by birth; the mode of establishing one with excellent application; the mode of establishing one with excellent intention; the mode of establishing the irreversible; the mode of establishing the youthful; the mode of establishing the regent; and the mode of establishing the bodhisattva who has attained sovereignty.

O sons of the Victors, those are the ten modes of establishing bodhisattvas as bodhisattvas. They were declared, they are declared, and they will be declared by the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, of the past, the future, and the present.

O sons of the Victors, what then is the mode of establishing the bodhisattva who has first aroused the mind? O sons of the Victors, in this regard, the bodhisattva who has first aroused the mind is one who, the very moment he beholds the buddhas, the Blessed Ones — whether seeing their beautiful form, their loveliness, the brilliance and breadth of their fine complexion, their great majesty, their miraculous displays of supernatural power, their miraculous displays of proclamation, or their miraculous displays of instruction — or who sees sentient beings in suffering, or who hears extensive praise of the Tathāgata, namely: longing for the gnosis of omniscience, right at the very outset arouses the mind toward unsurpassable, perfect, complete awakening.

At the very moment of having aroused that mind, he comes to fully embrace ten grounds that are difficult to approach. What are the ten? They are as follows: knowing what is proper ground and what is not; knowing the karma and phenomena that were properly undertaken in the past, the future, and the present; knowing the path that leads everywhere; knowing the many and varied elements; knowing the many aspirations and liberations; knowing the higher and lower faculties; knowing entirely the defilement and the purification of, and the arising from, the dhyānas, liberations, samādhis, and meditative absorptions; the knowledge of recollecting former abodes; the knowledge of the divine eye; and the knowledge of the exhaustion of defilements. He comes to fully embrace those ten grounds that are difficult to approach.

O sons of the Victors, this is the mode of establishing the bodhisattva who has first aroused the mind.

O sons of the Victors, the bodhisattva, the great being, who has first aroused the mind is to be engaged in the veneration of buddhas and in the provisions for a bodhisattva's welfare. One should also speak of how such a one becomes a lord of the world; how one is to be elevated and never overpowered; how one meets with immeasurable buddhas; how one is to practice in the meditative absorption of supreme peace; how one reverses the wheel of saṃsāra; how one turns the wheel of the sacred Dharma; and how one fully protects sentient beings who are suffering. And why is this? It is because, immediately upon arousing the mind, that very one strives greatly in all the qualities of a buddha and, for those stations of progress that have been heard, engages in them oneself, gaining the attainment of not depending upon others. O sons of the Victors, this is the mode of establishing the bodhisattva who has first aroused the mind.

O sons of the Victors, what then is the mode of establishing the bodhisattva who is a beginner? O sons of the Victors, here the bodhisattva who is a beginner first arouses ten kinds of mind toward sentient beings. What are those ten? They are as follows: the mind of bringing benefit; the mind of bringing happiness; the mind of tender affection; the mind of gentleness; the mind of love; the mind of bestowing benefit; the mind of all-encompassing protection; the mind of equanimity; the mind of a teacher; and the mind of a guide. These ten kinds of mind one arouses.

O sons of the Victors, this is the bodhisattva who is a beginner.

O sons of the Victors, this bodhisattva who is a beginner is to be engaged in receiving scriptural transmission and in recitation. Having heard extensively, one is to be engaged in thorough seclusion. Having attained thorough seclusion, one is to be engaged in joyful devotion to a spiritual friend. Having become joyfully devoted to a spiritual friend, one is to be engaged in being amenable to instruction. Having become amenable to instruction, one is to be engaged in knowing the right time. Having come to know the right time, one is to be engaged in fearlessness. Having become fearless, one is to be engaged in knowing the meaning. Having come to know the meaning, one is to be engaged in following the Dharma. Having come to follow the Dharma, one is to be engaged in the quality of not forgetting. Having become free from confusion, one is to be engaged in analyzing phenomena. And why is this? It is

because, immediately upon arousing the mind, that very one strives greatly in all the qualities of a buddha and, for those stations of progress that have been attained, also engages in them oneself, gaining the attainment of not depending upon others. O sons of the Victors, this is the mode of establishing the bodhisattva who is a beginner.

O sons of the Victors, what then is the mode of establishing the bodhisattva who practices yoga (Yogācāra)? O sons of the Victors, here the bodhisattva who practices yoga comprehends phenomena by means of ten kinds of contemplative focus. What are the ten? They are as follows: comprehending all phenomena as impermanence; comprehending all phenomena as suffering; as selflessness; as emptiness; as without motion; as without breath; as without abode; as without conceptuality; as without effort; and as without compounding activity. Because of having come to follow the Dharma, such a one does not strive by applying oneself, yet does not refrain from applying oneself either.

O sons of the Victors, this is the account of the bodhisattva who practices yoga. O sons of the Victors, that bodhisattva who practices yoga should apply himself to examining the element of sentient beings, to examining the dharmadhātu, to examining the element of the world, to examining the element of earth, to examining the element of water, the element of fire, the element of wind, the element of space, the element of form, and to examining the element of the formless. Why is this? It is because such a one, to a great degree, enters into the appearance of phenomena and, at whatever ground of further advancement one dwells, attains — with regard to those very topics one has heard — the ability to apply oneself to them directly rather than depending on another. O sons of the Victors, this is the account of the bodhisattva who practices yoga.

O sons of the Victors, what is the account of the bodhisattva who is supremely born? O sons of the Victors, in this regard the bodhisattva who is supremely born is one who is born into nobility through the sacred scriptures by means of ten purifying practices. What are the ten? They are as follows: not turning back from the nature of reality; perfecting the accomplishment of unshakeable faith in the buddhas to its ultimate degree; holding Dharma with certainty in mind; examining sentient beings; examining the buddha-field; examining the world; examining karma; examining karmic maturation; examining saṃsāra; and examining nirvāṇa. Through these ten purifying practices, such a one is born into nobility through the sacred scriptures. O sons of the Victors, this is the

bodhisattva who is supremely born.

O sons of the Victors, that bodhisattva who is supremely born should apply himself to examining the equality of the qualities of the buddhas of the past, to examining the equality of the qualities of the buddhas of the future, to examining the equality of the qualities of the buddhas of the present, and to examining the equality of the qualities of all buddhas. He should apply himself to examining the perfect accomplishment of the qualities of the buddhas of the past, of the buddhas of the future, of the buddhas of the present, and of all buddhas. He should apply himself to examining the equality of the complete accomplishment of the qualities of the buddhas of the past, of the buddhas of the future, of the buddhas of the present, and of all buddhas. Why is this? It is because such a one, to a great degree, realizes the equality of the three times, and attains — with regard to those very topics one has heard at whatever ground of further advancement one dwells — the ability to apply oneself to them directly rather than depending on another. O sons of the Victors, this is the account of the bodhisattva who is supremely born.

O sons of the Victors, what is the account of the bodhisattva of excellent application? O sons of the Victors, in this regard the bodhisattva of excellent application is one who, whatever virtuous action he undertakes, dedicates all of it to fully protecting every sentient being, to wishing benefit for every sentient being, to establishing every sentient being in happiness, to showing loving care for every sentient being, to fully liberating every sentient being,

to causing no harm to every sentient being, to guiding every sentient being, to inspiring faith in every sentient being, to taming every sentient being, and to fully drawing every sentient being beyond sorrow. O sons of the Victors, this is the account of the bodhisattva of excellent application.

O sons of the Victors, ten grounds are to be correctly declared for that bodhisattva of excellent application. What are the ten? They are as follows: sentient beings are boundless; sentient beings are immeasurable; sentient beings are uncountable; sentient beings are inconceivable; sentient beings are incomparable; sentient beings are immeasurable beyond reckoning; sentient beings are empty; sentient beings are without movement; sentient beings are non-existent; and sentient beings are without intrinsic nature. Why is this? It is because, by settling the mind on that which is free from gross grasping and attachment, and dwelling in what is higher, one attains — at those very grounds that have been heard — the ability to rely on oneself rather than

depending on another. O sons of the Victors, this is the presentation of the bodhisattva of excellent application.

O sons of the Victors, what is the presentation of the bodhisattva of excellent intention? O sons of the Victors, in this regard the bodhisattva of excellent intention is one who, upon hearing ten qualities of the Dharma, is firmly resolved in intention toward the qualities of the buddhas. What are the ten? They are as follows: whether the praises of the buddhas or their dispraises are spoken, he is firmly resolved in intention toward the qualities of the buddhas. Whether the praises of the Dharma or its dispraises are spoken, and whether the praises of the bodhisattvas or their dispraises are spoken, he is firmly resolved in intention toward the qualities of the buddhas. Whether the conduct of the bodhisattvas is praised or dispraised, he is firmly resolved in intention toward the qualities of the buddhas. Whether it is said that the realm of sentient beings is narrow, or that it is vast, or that the realm of sentient beings is entirely afflicted, or that it is not entirely afflicted, or that the realm of sentient beings is easy to tame, or that it is difficult to tame, or that the dharmadhātu is narrow, or that the dharmadhātu is vast, or that the world-systems are destructible or indestructible, or that the dharmadhātu exists or does not exist — whatever may be spoken, he is firmly resolved in intention toward the qualities of the buddhas. O sons of the Victors, this is the bodhisattva of excellent intention.

O sons of the Victors, ten accordances with the Dharma are to be correctly declared for that bodhisattva of excellent intention. What are the ten? They are as follows: all phenomena are to be correctly declared as being without signs; all phenomena are to be correctly declared as being without defining characteristics, without substance, without existence, as being false, as being secluded, as being without essential nature, as being like an illusion, as being like a dream, and as being without conceptual thought. Why is this? It is because, not being distracted from this, he becomes one whose characteristic is the greatly increasing superior intention, and, dwelling in what is higher, one attains — at those very grounds that have been heard — the ability to rely on oneself rather than depending on another. O sons of the Victors, this is the presentation of the bodhisattva of excellent intention.

O sons of the Victors, what is the presentation of the irreversible bodhisattva?

O sons of the Victors, in this regard, the irreversible bodhisattva, upon hearing ten objects of focus, does not turn back from the qualities of a buddha. What

are the ten? They are as follows. Even upon hearing that a buddha exists or does not exist, he does not turn back from the qualities of a buddha. Even upon hearing that Dharma exists or does not exist; that bodhisattvas exist or do not exist; that the conduct of bodhisattvas exists or does not exist; that bodhisattvas definitely emerge or definitely do not emerge into the conduct of bodhisattvas; that the Tathāgatas have passed into nirvāṇa or have not passed into nirvāṇa; that the Tathāgatas have come or have not come; that the Tathāgatas have arisen at the present time or have not arisen at the present time; that the wisdom of the buddhas is exhausted or is inexhaustible; and even upon hearing that the three times share a single characteristic or do not share a single characteristic — he does not turn back from the qualities of a buddha. O sons of the Victors, this is the irreversible bodhisattva.

O sons of the Victors, ten streams of Dharma are to be rightly proclaimed concerning that irreversible bodhisattva. What are the ten? They are as follows. That all phenomena are rightly proclaimed as being of one nature and as being of distinct natures; as being many and as being one; as the meaning being superimposed upon the word; as the word being superimposed upon the meaning; as existence superimposing non-existence; as non-existence superimposing existence; as signs superimposing the absence of signs; as the absence of signs superimposing signs; as characteristics superimposing the absence of characteristics; and as the absence of characteristics superimposing characteristics — all these are to be rightly proclaimed. Why is this? It is because, being greatly skilled in all phenomena in this way, he emerges with certainty into the manner of thorough ripening, and, dwelling in what is higher, he attains — at those very grounds that have been heard — the ability to rely on himself rather than depending on another. O sons of the Victors, this is the presentation of the irreversible bodhisattva.

O sons of the Victors, what is the presentation of the youthful bodhisattva?

O sons of the Victors, in this regard, the youthful bodhisattva is endowed with ten realizations of Dharma. What are the ten? They are as follows. He is endowed with the understanding that actions of body bear results. He is endowed with the understanding that actions of speech bear results. He is endowed with the understanding that actions of mind bear results. By the mere arising of a thought he accomplishes birth in a manifest form. He knows the intentions of other sentient beings and other individuals, and discerns their aspirations. He thoroughly knows the diversity of the constitutions of sentient beings. He thoroughly knows the diversity of the desire realm. He thoroughly

knows the diversity of the form realm. He thoroughly knows the diversity of the formless realm. And because he proceeds in accordance with time as it truly is, his superknowledge is swift. O sons of the Victors, this is the youthful bodhisattva.

O sons of the Victors, ten manifest accomplishments of Dharma are to be rightly proclaimed concerning that youthful bodhisattva. What are the ten? They are as follows: the thorough knowledge of buddha fields; causing buddha fields to tremble; blessing buddha fields; examining buddha fields; traveling to buddha fields; traveling to world-systems without number; asking innumerable questions; manifestly accomplishing the mental body; engaging with sounds and voices without measure; and, through the arising of a single thought, bringing innumerable buddha fields to complete fulfillment — these are to be rightly proclaimed. Why is this?

This is because that one is skilled in accomplishing this to a high degree, and attains, with respect to those grounds heard of above, the ability to accomplish by oneself without relying on another. Sons of the Victors, this is the presentation of the youthful bodhisattva.

Sons of the Victors, what then is the presentation of the regent bodhisattva? Sons of the Victors, in this regard the regent bodhisattva is skilled in ten things to be comprehended. What are the ten? They are as follows: being skilled in comprehending the births of sentient beings; being skilled in comprehending the movements of afflictions; being skilled in comprehending the connecting links of habitual tendencies; being skilled in comprehending engagement with objects of activity; being skilled in comprehending the nature of reality; being skilled in comprehending what is to be practiced; being skilled in comprehending the distinctions among world-systems; being skilled in comprehending the former limit, the latter limit, and what has arisen in the present; and being skilled in definitely comprehending conventional truth. Sons of the Victors, this is the regent bodhisattva.

Sons of the Victors, ten grounds are to be rightly proclaimed with regard to the regent bodhisattva. What are the ten? They are as follows: being skilled in the royal palace retinue is to be rightly proclaimed; moving throughout the royal palace retinue; entering the royal palace retinue; thoroughly examining the royal palace retinue; the consecration of the Dharma king; the blessing of the Dharma king; overcoming adversaries of the Dharma king; the abode of the Dharma king; and the command-scripture of the Dharma king — these are to

be rightly proclaimed. Why is this? Because that one's mind engages to a high degree in accomplishing unobstructed penetration of all phenomena, and attains, with respect to those grounds heard of above, the ability to accomplish by oneself without relying on another. Sons of the Victors, this is the presentation of the regent bodhisattva.

Sons of the Victors, what then is the presentation of the bodhisattva who has received consecration? Sons of the Victors, in this regard the bodhisattva who has received consecration is endowed with ten manifest accomplishments of knowledge. What are the ten? They are as follows: causing innumerable world-systems to tremble greatly; blessing innumerable world-systems greatly; traversing innumerable world-systems with a single thought; thoroughly purifying innumerable world-systems; discerning, with a single thought, the minds of innumerable sentient beings; surveying innumerable world-systems greatly; being skilled in examining, with a single thought, the mental conduct of innumerable sentient beings; being skilled in comprehending, with a single thought, the faculties of innumerable sentient beings; being skilled in taming innumerable sentient beings; and being skilled in leading innumerable sentient beings into the mind of omniscience.

Sons of the Victors, no bodhisattva dwelling on stages below the regent's stage is able to know the bodily actions of that bodhisattva who has received consecration, nor to know his verbal actions, nor to know his mental actions, nor to know his miraculous powers, nor to know his survey of miraculous powers.

They are unable to know his survey of the past, unable to know his intentional formations, unable to know his intellectual survey, unable to know the domain of his mind, and unable to know the domain of his wisdom. Sons of the Victors, this is the bodhisattva who has received consecration.

Sons of the Victors, to that bodhisattva who has received consecration, the blessed buddhas proclaim ten abiding qualities. What are the ten? They are these: knowing the three times; knowing the qualities of the buddhas; knowing the dharmadhātu as undivided; knowing the dharmadhātu as without edge or center; filling all world-systems to fullness; illuminating all world-systems; consecrating all world-systems; knowing all sentient beings completely; directly knowing all phenomena; and proclaiming the boundless wisdom of the buddhas. And why is this? Because his mind enters supremely and fully into omniscience. Sons of the Victors, this is the presentation of the bodhisattva

who has received consecration.

Immediately after the bodhisattva Dharmabuddhi had expounded these ten presentations of the bodhisattvas, the great beings, at that very moment, through the power of the buddhas, world-systems equal in number to the finest particles of ten thousand buddha-fields trembled, in all ten directions, each direction alike, in six ways: they shook, they greatly shook, they shook in every part; they quaked, they greatly quaked, they quaked in every part; they rocked, they greatly rocked, they rocked in every part; they resounded, they greatly resounded, they resounded in every part; they reverberated, they greatly reverberated, they reverberated in every part; they stirred, they greatly stirred, they stirred in every part. Through the power of the buddhas and through the attainment of the nature of reality, clouds of divine flowers rained down; clouds of divine incense rained down; clouds of divine perfume rained down; and there rained down clouds of divine powder, clouds of divine garlands, clouds of divine garments, clouds of divine jewels, clouds of divine lotuses, clouds of divine ornamental necklaces, and clouds of divine adornments. The divine musical instruments sounded without being struck. Divine radiance blazed forth. Divine voices rang out. Just as it occurred here in this continent of the four lands, in the palace of Śakra, the lord of the gods, at the peak of Mount Meru, so too this teaching of the Dharma spread throughout every single world-system, without exception. These very words reveal this very meaning.

Through the power of the buddhas, bodhisattvas equal in number to the finest particles of ten thousand buddha-fields arrived from beyond world-systems equal in number to the finest particles of ten thousand buddha-fields, and having filled the ten directions to fullness, they spoke these words: Excellent! Excellent! O son of the Victors, it is well that you have taught this nature of the Dharma of the bodhisattvas. O sons of the Victors, we too bear only the name Dharmabuddhi. We have come here from world-systems called Clouds of Dharma, directly from the presence of Tathāgatas bearing the name Excellent Dharmabuddhi. Through the blessing of the buddhas, this teaching of the Dharma arose throughout all those places, and in assemblies such as this one, these very words reveal this very meaning, without exception. O son of the Victors, we are under your sway and have come to this world-system here through the power of the buddhas.

Just as we have come to this world-system here, so too have bodhisattvas gone to all four continents of every world-system in all ten directions — to the

palaces of Śakra (Indra, king of the gods) atop Mount Meru — in a number equal to the finest particles of dust in ten buddha fields.

The Second Fascicle.

Then, through the power of the buddhas, the bodhisattva Dharmabuddhi looked out in all ten directions, surveyed the entire retinue assembled there, and gazed into the dharmadhātu. At that moment he spoke these verses:

Beholding one who is self-arisen, of supremely pure intelligence,
beautiful and endowed with the power of form,
adorned with marks that are difficult to approach and see,
one plants the mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

Beholding the matchless powers of miraculous ability,
the teachings of excellent speech and what follows from them,
and seeing beings of the world worn down by suffering and loss,
one plants the mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

Hearing of the qualities of the Tathāgata, the source of all good qualities,
and of the qualities of Samantabhadra,
which are like the expanse of space — changeless and vast —
one plants the mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

In order to thoroughly comprehend all existing abodes,
and those other abodes that remain in their intrinsic nature,
as distinct from others, as they truly are in themselves,
one plants the mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

In order to comprehend the causes
of all virtuous and non-virtuous actions
that exist in past, future, and present times,
one plants the mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

In order to comprehend the proper occasion
for meditative absorption, dhyāna, the liberations, their practice,
and likewise the pure and ultimate meditative attainments,
one plants this mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

In order to comprehend, in each case, the respective sequence
of the faculties, the powers, and the diligence of beings in the world —
each in its own kind and measure —
one plants the mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

In order to comprehend the many treatises
through the aspirations of all beings in the world —
however they may be — and through the three distinct kinds of superior
intention,
one plants the mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

In order to comprehend the intrinsic nature of the elements —
the manifold elements of many kinds
that exist throughout these three worlds —
one plants that mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

In order to comprehend the true intrinsic nature
of all that is pervasive in this Dharma,
and of all wholesome engagement that is thoroughly entered,
one plants the mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

In order to open the unattached eye that discerns
how all the fields come into being,
and how sentient beings arise from their respective grounds,
one plants this mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

In order to comprehend, in past time and present time,
the specific characteristics of the classes of sentient beings,
and to comprehend their former abodes,
one plants this mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

In order to comprehend the exhaustion of the afflictions —
the fetters that bind sentient beings as they wander,
and all the bonds (saṃyojana) that exist in the world —
one plants this mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

In order to comprehend the truth of conventions —
all the designations applied in the three worlds,
and whatever paths of speech, forms of mantra, and customary conduct exist
—
one plants this mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

For all phenomena are inexpressible —
empty, unmoving, the essential nature as it is —
in order to comprehend the ultimate truth,
one plants the mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

In order to display the trembling of the earth in the pure fields,
and the great churning of the oceans,
and to reveal the miraculous powers of the Tathāgata —
one plants this mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

From the tip of a single ray of light, rays upon rays
spread out everywhere throughout the ten directions —
in order to comprehend those lights as one,
one plants this mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

The inconceivably many pure fields,
one manifests them all directly in the palm of one's hand —
in order to comprehend that manner of illusion,
one plants this mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

Just as those fields are, so too all sentient beings,
one places in the hollow of one's palm without harm to any —
in order to comprehend that all phenomena are without life,
one plants this mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

All the waters there are in the oceans,
one causes to enter within a single drop balanced on the tip of a hair —
in order to comprehend this thoroughly and to its end,
one plants this mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

The number of subtle dust particles in all the fields —
each and every one of them without remainder one counts —
in order to comprehend the measure of those subtle particles,
one plants this mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

In this world, the terrors of the conflagration at the end of the age,
past and likewise future —
in order to comprehend the exhaustion of an aeon,
one plants this mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

The Tathāgatas of the three times,
and the Teachers — pratyekabuddhas and śrāvakas alike —
in order to comprehend the intrinsic nature of Dharma in them all,
one plants this mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

The inexpressibly many world-systems,
bound up with a single hair and weighed without remainder on a scale —
in order to comprehend the intrinsic nature of things,

one plants this mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

The inconceivably many encircling mountain ranges,
bound up with a single hair and weighed without remainder on a scale —
in order to comprehend the gross and the subtle,
one plants this mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

Throughout world-systems without remainder,
in a single instant one makes heard by means of melodious sound —
in order to display the pure branches of melody,
one plants this mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

All the sounds of every world, whatever they may be,
in a single instant one utters in that very instant —
in order to comprehend the intrinsic nature of peace,
one plants this mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

All three worlds without remainder one comprehends,
fully known by all sentient beings —
in order to comprehend the broad and vast tongue,
one plants this mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

Throughout all the fields, just as with a word spoken,
in a single instant one dispels wrong views —
in order to comprehend phenomena as conceptual constructs,
one plants this mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

Here, in all the fields without exception,
whatever naturally arisen phenomena the Tathāgata pervades —
in order to comprehend them in a single instant,
one plants this mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

Like the diversity of fine particles, world-systems
one manifests in every manner and in every mode —
in order to comprehend the joys arising from mind,
one plants this mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

All the buddhas past and likewise those yet to come,
however many dwell throughout the world —
in order to comprehend them in a single instant of mind,
one plants this mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

Though one utters but a single word, through incalculable
aeons exhausted thereby it suffers no diminishment —
in order to comprehend the distinctions among excellent words,
one plants this mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

In all the worlds of the ten directions —
what the migrations of beings are like and what their reversals are like —
in order to comprehend them in a single instant of mind,
one plants this mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

Going throughout all directions, whether by body,
by speech, or by mind, one is attached to nowhere —
in order to comprehend the three times as emptiness,
one plants this mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening.

Just as the awakening mind is aroused,
so too, for incalculable aeons, one travels throughout all directions
and makes offerings in the presence of the buddhas —
this is the teaching given to those who do not turn back.

Throughout the distinct worlds of the ten directions,
becoming a son of the Victors who is lord of the world —
proclaiming whatever is excellent and sublime —
this is the teaching given to those who do not turn back.

When one practices and conducts oneself in existence for the sake of
awakening,
one constantly proclaims the praises of whatever bliss and union
belong to the bodhisattva —
this is the teaching given to those who do not turn back.

The supreme Dharma, the utterly sublime Dharma,
and whatever unsurpassable Dharma is distinctly exalted —
these one teaches to bodhisattvas —
this is the teaching given to those who do not turn back.

The Tathāgata endowed with every quality
exists in this very life and nowhere else —
to that one the bodhisattva applies himself —
this is the teaching given to those who do not turn back.

What it is like to encounter buddhas
immeasurable, incalculable, and inconceivable —

this one teaches to that bodhisattva —
this is the teaching given to those who do not turn back.

All the meditative absorptions (samādhi) that exist,
and likewise the various aspects and streams of those absorptions —
these one expounds to the sons of the Sugata —
this is the teaching given to those who do not turn back.

The reversal of the wheel of saṃsāra
and the setting in motion of the wheel of the sacred Dharma —
which the entire world has not yet caused to turn —
this should be taught to the bodhisattvas.

One who has become refuge, sanctuary, and ally
for all the worlds in extreme suffering
and for those afflicted in the realms of lower destinies —
this should be taught to the bodhisattvas.

One who places the mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening
is to be regarded as a first-stage bodhisattva.
The instructions on training, precisely determined,
and this precise arrangement of the teaching — these belong to that one.

Just as the flawless ones teach,
in order to benefit the entire world,
one who arouses the mind in this way at the very beginning —
this is described as twofold: the first-stage practitioner.

Minds directed toward benefit, excellence, and ease;
minds of friendship, affection, and gathering in;
minds of universal protection and equanimity;
minds of the master and minds of teaching with equanimity —

One in whom such minds have become established
should be applied to the practice of receiving scriptural transmission and
recitation.

Having listened widely, one should be led to dwell in a hermitage.
Having become secluded, one should be led to rely upon a spiritual friend
(kalyāṇamitra).

Toward spiritual friends one should be easy to instruct.

One should know the proper time and be possessed of introspective

awareness.

Having come to know the time, one should be utterly fearless.

Being free of fear, one should be diligent in what is meaningful.

Having come to know the meaning, one should teach the Dharma accordingly.

With respect to all phenomena, one should be free of bewilderment.

Being free of bewilderment, as a son of the Victors,
one should abide in the well-spoken Dharma.

This is the description of the first-stage practitioner —
the bodhisattva who has entered upon awakening.

This is the instruction; this is the teaching;
whoever trains in this is a child of the buddhas.

The third type of bodhisattva
applies himself thoroughly to the teaching of the Dharma-king.
Impermanence, suffering, emptiness,
selflessness, and the absence of agitation —
that all these phenomena likewise are not a self,
that there is no deliberate striving, and that they are solitude —
that all of these are free of conceptual thought —
in this way does that bodhisattva reflect.

For the purpose of examining the realm of sentient beings and the
dharmadhātu,

that one is also to be encouraged with praise.

"The realm of the world is endless and boundless" —

in this way one should lead that person to such investigation.

Here there is earth, water, and likewise fire —

wind and space in whatever measure they exist,

and in the directions: the desire realm, the form realm, and the formless realm
—

into investigation of all of these that one is to be led.

The thorough and ultimate examination of the intrinsic nature of all the vast
phenomena and all the elements —

this is the instruction that is given for the benefit of those who take up the
path, the sons of the buddha.

Whatever bodhisattva is born into birth,
arises within the teaching and goes forth into renunciation.

That one of keen intelligence realizes the absence of things and the presence

of things,
is born in the abode of the true Dharma, and is well born.
That one does not turn back from their own ground;
the conviction arises that the buddha is the ultimate.
One is always endowed with a mind certain in the Dharma,
and examines thoroughly what the nature of sentient beings is like —
karma, worlds, pure realms and buddha-fields,
karmic maturation, retinues, and nirvāṇa —
these distinctions the son of the Victor knows.
That one is called a bodhisattva born of the awakening mind.

Having examined the phenomena of omniscience — past, present,
and those yet to come — what the accomplishment is like
of the perfectly accomplished, the supremely well-born, the ultimate,
and those who are self-arisen —
all those holy buddhas have entered into the equal nature of the three times,
and they know it.

That equality they never distinguish into separate parts;
thus one enters into the non-difference of the three times.
One who possesses qualities of such a kind —
that is the fourth bodhisattva.

A bodhisattva who has thoroughly accomplished these things
will assuredly emerge for the sake of awakening.

In this way the fifth bodhisattva
is said to be perfectly endowed with application.

Entering into the path of skillful means,
one brings to completion the works of virtuous merit.
Thus, whatever one accomplishes through that merit,
one becomes a support for all the world,
desires to benefit and enables the attainment of happiness,
is compassionate, and liberates living beings.

For the sake of taming those in the world who have gone astray,
one guides them and gladdens them.

One desires to tame the great multitude of sentient beings,
and with a mind set on nirvāṇa the power is great.

One knows the nature of all the world as boundless,
likewise immeasurable and innumerable,
incomparable, inconceivable, unequaled, immense,

empty, unagitated, and absent.

That is the fifth bodhisattva —

perfectly gathered in application, endowed with benefit and compassion.

The instruction given to that one is as follows,

as taught by those endowed with all qualities.

That one is not bewildered with regard to all infinite sentient beings

and with regard to the essential nature of the Dharma.

Of extremely keen intelligence, free of thought, free of conceptuality,

that one is inseparable from the world together with its gods.

Whether one hears of buddhas, Dharma, and bodhisattvas,

of praiseworthy conduct or of what is not praiseworthy,

of sentient beings as small or as great —

even upon hearing such things, the mind is not shaken.

Whether sentient beings are afflicted or purified,

easy to tame or difficult to tame,

whether the dharmadhātu is small or vast,

whether it perishes or remains, whether it exists or does not exist —

Even hearing all such things, that bodhisattva

who has realized the three times examines all with certainty,

and is thoroughly resolved in mind:

the intention within this buddha-Dharma is utterly certain.

That one listens to this supreme, peaceful Dharma —

signless, without defining marks,

without things, of illusory nature, false and solitary,

of illusory nature, unmoved, and like to stillness.

Thus the irreversible bodhisattva

examines with certainty: do buddhas, Dharma, and bodhisattvas,

and their conduct, exist or not?

Even if asked whether they arise or do not arise, that one does not turn back.

Whether the Tathāgata has passed away or has not passed away,

whether the Tathāgata has not yet come or is not one who has not come,

whether arisen or not arisen, exhausted or inexhaustible —

likewise whether having one defining mark or having no defining mark —

whether one or many in aspect,

whether ultimate or verbal, existent or non-existent —

all of these being superimpositions, merely other in nature:
the irreversible bodhisattva places confident trust in this.

Without defining marks and with defining marks,
without characteristics and characterized by characteristics,
the various distinctions and their mutual combinations —
hearing all of this, that one enters to the very end of it.

The youthful bodhisattva
performs through body, speech, and likewise mind
those actions that bear fruit,
and manifests birth here just as desired.

That one discerns the intentions of others
and acts in accordance with their aspirations.
That one knows the conduct of sentient beings and the Dharma in harmony
with it,
and knows the arising and dissolution of buddha-fields.

That one swiftly attains the superknowledges that grant what is desired,
and directs the mind into all directions.
Hearing the qualities praised by the Sugata,
that one feels no distress at any of it.

One should speak of how to fully know, how to cause the field to tremble, how
likewise to consecrate, how to discern, and how one proceeds through
innumerable instants to buddha-fields.

That one asks innumerable questions,
and displays a mind-body just as the physical bodies appear.
There the joining of sounds and voices is inexhaustible,
and in a single instant innumerable buddhas are spoken of.

The bodhisattva who is a regent
knows exactly how sentient beings enter.
That one is skilled in understanding their afflictive continuums and habitual
tendencies,
their sphere of activity and their engagement,
whatever their various phenomena and movements are,
the distinctions of the world and its beginning,
the conventional truth and the ultimate truth —

knowing all of these without exception, that one is truly wise.

That one is fully equipped with skill regarding palace and retinue,
and in that regard one should speak of how to conduct oneself throughout,
how to take up residence and likewise how to enter,
how the palace and retinue are to be examined,
what the royal empowerment of the sacred Dharma is like,
what the consecration and the surpassing of others is like,
and the entering into Dharma and the declaring of scriptural teaching —
this is the entering of the stage of the regent.

That much constitutes the culmination of that one,
and things do not change otherwise than as taught.
When the day comes to cast off the formations of life,
the rightful regent directly approaches victory.

The one who receives the empowerment is the single child of the Sugata,
the eldest, supremely distinguished, of ultimate selfhood.
By a single drop of hair-tip, one may measure the ocean's depth,
yet the intention here cannot be fathomed by counting.

The conduct of the children of the Victor is like this:
all the buddha-fields here, along with all sentient beings,
may be ground down to the finest dust without remainder,
and that many, one may declare — innumerable, this many —
yet all of that the bodhisattva here knows.

The awakening mind gives rise to the seed
of buddhas past, buddhas yet to come, and those dwelling in the ten
directions,
as well as of pratyekabuddhas and likewise śrāvakas.

What is called the awakening mind at the very beginning:
even in terms of how great a thing it is, that is innumerable.
If it were to pervade this entire world-system entirely,
what beyond that could still be said?

Then the bodhisattva Samantabhadra spoke thus to the bodhisattva
Dharmamati: Son of good family, you have spoken well in explaining the
dhāraṇī of the precious tālā. Son of good family, the qualities of a buddha are
inconceivable. Even those sentient beings who merely hear the name of this

Dharma teaching come close to omniscience — how much more need be said of those who hold this Dharma teaching, who read it, who bring it to complete fulfilment, and who practise it in accordance with suchness.

They will most certainly become buddhas.

Dharmamati spoke: O son of the Victors, it is indeed so, just as has been said. Know that those endowed with profound wisdom have been empowered by the Tathāgata.

The bodhisattva Samantabhadra spoke: If this Dharma teaching reaches the ears of any son or daughter of good family, those noble persons too should be understood to have been prophesied concerning the qualities of a buddha — how much more need be said of those who have personally received this enumeration of Dharma teachings in hand.

Then the Venerable Śāradvatīputra prostrated with his head at the feet of the Blessed One and spoke thus: Blessed One, pray consider this: because I had not sought out such Dharma teachings as these, I am like a blind man. Blessed One, I do not lament only that I myself have become like a blind man — Blessed One, all those sentient beings who have not heard this enumeration of Dharma teachings have likewise become as though blind.

The Blessed One declared: Elder, it is indeed so, just as you have said.

Śāradvatīputra submitted: Blessed One, pray expound the inconceivable.

The Blessed One declared: Śāradvatīputra, go and summon Śakra (Indra, king of the gods), Brahmā, and all the world-guardians. Proclaim the word of the Tathāgata. Proclaim to that assembly also this dhāraṇī called the Precious Tālā, the Noble Seal of the Dharma. Then, having heard the word of the Tathāgata, the Venerable Śāradvatīputra, thoroughly thirsting for the meaning of this dhāraṇī of the Precious Tālā, addressed Śakra, Brahmā, and all the world-guardians on this occasion, saying: Assemble all those who wish to hear the Dharma. The Tathāgata will expound the dhāraṇī of the Precious Tālā and will also reveal the inconceivable — assemble them. Lest you later come to regret it: O friends, the arising in the world of precious sūtras such as this is exceedingly rare.

Then, in that very instant, Śakra, Brahmā, and all the world-guardians assembled, circumambulated the Blessed One three times, stood in the presence of the Blessed One with palms pressed together, and petitioned him: Blessed One, pray expound the dhāraṇī of the Precious Tālā.

The Blessed One then remained silent, and by that silence gave his consent. Even as Śakra, Brahmā, and all the world-guardians petitioned him a second and a third time, the Blessed One still remained silent.

Then the Venerable Śāradvatīputra addressed the Blessed One in these words: Blessed One, pray expound the dhāraṇī called the Precious Tālā. May the Sugata expound it.

Thereupon the Blessed One extended his tongue from his mouth and, with that voice, caused it to be heard throughout the great trichiliocosm (the vast three-thousandfold world-system): all those sons of good family who, for the sake of this dhāraṇī of the Precious Tālā, supplicate the Tathāgata will become irreversible from unsurpassable, perfect, and complete awakening.

Then the Blessed One again addressed the Venerable Śāradvatīputra in these words: Śāradvatīputra, go and beseech the youthful Mañjuśrī to teach the Dharma. At that time the youthful Mañjuśrī was seated cross-legged at the foot of another śāla tree — a tree of the bhlātkṣa and śāla — his body motionless and still.

He was seated in a many-storied mansion of magnificent and magnificent color and arrangement, resplendent beyond what even ten billion suns could illumine, surrounded and attended upon by Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods), Brahmā, and the world-guardians, his body like the hue of gold, blazing and shining with splendor and glory.

Then the Venerable Śāradvatīputra went to where the youthful Mañjuśrī was, and when he had arrived, he spoke to the youthful Mañjuśrī in these words: Son of good family, the Tathāgata beseeches you to teach the Dharma.

Then the youthful Mañjuśrī spoke to the Venerable Śāradvatīputra in these words: Venerable Śāradvatīputra, what is the underlying meaning of the very term "Tathāgata"?

Śāradvatīputra replied: Son of good family, you are one of profound wisdom; I am not able to debate with you on this.

Mañjuśrī said: Sit there with a little courage in your heart, and teach it just as you yourself understand it.

Śāradvatīputra said: Son of good family, I am listening — please speak.

Then the youthful Mañjuśrī arose from that meditative absorption and caused the great trichiliocosm to resound with his voice.

At that moment, all the divine sons throughout the great trichiliocosm — from those of the Pure Abode class down to those of Akaniṣṭha — gathered together. The four great kings, together with their armies and retinues, also assembled along with many tens of millions of yakṣas. Śakra, Brahmā, and the world-guardians also assembled. Those who desired the Dharma and those persons who did not desire the Dharma also assembled. Many divine daughters also assembled. The assembly of monks, the assembly of nuns, the assembly of laymen, and the assembly of laywomen assembled, as did the assembly of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, the assembly of the Heaven Free from Strife, the assembly of the Tuṣita Heaven, the assembly of the Heaven of Delight in Transformation, the assembly of the gods of the Heaven of Mastery over Others' Creations, the assembly of Brahmā, and likewise the assemblies of the gods all the way up to Akaniṣṭha.

In the same way the assembly of śrāvakas also gathered — namely: the Venerable Subhūti, the Venerable Mahākāśyapa, the Venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, the Venerable Śāradvatīputra, the Venerable Mahākātyāyana, the Venerable Aniruddha, the Venerable Gayākāśyapa, the Venerable Trisaṃbha, the Venerable Panthaka, the Venerable Nanda, the Venerable Nadīkāśyapa, the Venerable Uruvilvākāśyapa, the Venerable Pūrṇamaitrāyaṇīputra, the Venerable Rāhula, the Venerable Svāgata, the Venerable Vāṣpa, the Venerable Ānanda — these and other great śrāvakas, as well as five hundred nuns led by Dhṛtaśīlā and others, also assembled. Kings of realms and wheel-turning monarchs also assembled. Assemblies of the kṣatriya, brahmin, and householder classes also assembled.

Then the Venerable Śāradvatīputra circumambulated the Blessed One three times and addressed him in these words: Blessed One, by whose power has this great assembly gathered here today in this way? How ought one to receive it?

The Blessed One declared:

Venerable Śāradvatīputra, this is the power of the Ratnatāla dhāraṇī. Śāradvatīputra then requested: Blessed One, I wish to hear the Ratnatāla dhāraṇī. The Blessed One declared: Śāradvatīputra, go and make your request to the youthful Mañjuśrī and to the bodhisattva Samantabhadra.

Then the Venerable Śāradvatīputra said these words to the youthful Mañjuśrī: Noble son, please set forth this Ratnatāla, this precious dhāraṇī of meditative absorption. Mañjuśrī replied: Venerable Śāradvatīputra, who then will hear the

Ratnatāla dhāraṇī? Śāradvatīputra said: These four assemblies gathered here, and these assembled ones — Śakra, Brahmā, and the world-protectors — and I myself have come in order to hear it.

Then the youthful Mañjuśrī said these words to the elder Śāradvatīputra: Elder Śāradvatīputra, if all these listeners of the Dharma have truly arisen from illusion, then to whom shall I teach the Dharma? Who is the listener? Who is the teacher? The elder said: Noble one, please speak — I shall listen. Mañjuśrī replied: Venerable Śāradvatīputra, the very word "speak" — whose word is that? He said: Mañjuśrī, the word "speak" is the word of emptiness. Mañjuśrī said: Venerable Śāradvatīputra, and the word "emptiness" — whose word is that? He said: Mañjuśrī, emptiness is beyond words. Mañjuśrī then said: Venerable Śāradvatīputra, if emptiness is beyond words, then what is there to teach? Venerable Śāradvatīputra, all phenomena are beyond demonstration — they are beyond demonstration and beyond hearing.

The elder said: Noble son, everything you have set forth in this way is a demonstration of emptiness, a demonstration of signlessness, a demonstration of wishlessness, a demonstration of nothing to take up, a demonstration of nothing to cast aside, a demonstration of freedom from conceptual elaboration — it is a demonstration of non-elaboration.

Then the entire assembly of bodhisattvas, together with Śakra, Brahmā, and the world-protectors, were filled with great joy and with one voice declared to the youthful Mañjuśrī and the Venerable Śāradvatīputra: "Excellent! This Ratnatāla dhāraṇī has been well expounded."

Then the Venerable Subhūti said these words to the youthful Mañjuśrī: Mañjuśrī, how should a bodhisattva take up this Ratnatāla dhāraṇī, recite it, bring it to complete fulfillment, and expound it widely and correctly to others? Mañjuśrī replied: Subhūti, this dhāraṇī should be held in mind as birthless, as without things, as without defining characteristics, as without conceptual elaboration, as without anything to cast aside.

When the youthful Mañjuśrī taught this exposition of the Dharma, ninety-two bodhisattvas in that assembly attained the meditative absorption of courageous progression, and sixty-two gods and humans attained acceptance of the birthlessness of phenomena.

Then the bodhisattva Samantabhadra rose from his seat, arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, joined his palms together, and addressed the Blessed One in these words: Blessed One, what is the nature of the great compassion

of bodhisattva great beings? The Blessed One declared: Noble son, the great compassion of bodhisattva great beings consists in this: not abandoning the three realms entirely — this is great compassion.

That which shows all sentient beings buddha fields everywhere — this is great compassion. That which completely embraces sentient beings who have broken their moral discipline — this is great compassion. That which does not abandon the Perfection of Wisdom — this is great compassion. That which gives up body and life entirely for the sake of all sentient beings — this is great compassion. That which properly proclaims loving-kindness to sentient beings engaged in attachment and desire — this is great compassion. That which extends loving-kindness to sentient beings who possess power — this is great compassion of bodhisattva great beings.

Noble son, furthermore, bodhisattva great beings should cultivate a mind free from enmity toward all sentient beings, and should cultivate impartiality in abundance.

Then the bodhisattva Samantabhadra addressed the Blessed One in these words: For the benefit and well-being of the many, out of compassion for the world, for the sake of the great multitude and of gods and humans — for their benefit, welfare, and happiness — may the Blessed One please teach the dhāraṇī called Ratnataḷa. You who possess compassion and healing for all sentient beings, O Blessed One, please teach it.

Then the Blessed One, in the voice of Brahmā, declared to those bodhisattvas: Among you, who aspires to teach this category of Dharma fully and correctly in the last era, the final five-hundred-year period, when the holy Dharma is in decline?

Thereupon the bodhisattva Samantabhadra, the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī the Ever-Youthful, the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, the bodhisattva Mahāsthāmaprāpta (Greatly Powerful Attainment), the bodhisattva Remover of Evil Destinies, the bodhisattva King of Healing Medicine, the bodhisattva Stacked Confidence, the bodhisattva King Supremely Exalted through All Phenomena, the bodhisattva Inexhaustible Intelligence, the bodhisattva Ocean of Intelligence, the bodhisattva Adorned with Precious Splendor, the bodhisattva Jewel-Light, the bodhisattva Crown-Jewel Bearer, the bodhisattva Clear-Sighted, the bodhisattva Unseen by Looking, the bodhisattva Ever-Watchful, the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, the bodhisattva Heap of Jewels, the bodhisattva Source of Jewels, the bodhisattva Dharma-Splendor, the

bodhisattva Thought-Splendor, the bodhisattva Wealth-Splendor, the bodhisattva Merit-Splendor, the bodhisattva Sandalwood-Splendor, the bodhisattva Intelligence of the Dharma, the bodhisattva Nectar Intelligence, the bodhisattva Boundless Intelligence, the bodhisattva Adorned with Merit, the bodhisattva Adorned with Qualities, the bodhisattva Adorned with Marks, the bodhisattva Ever-Laughing, Greatly Delighting All Faculties, the bodhisattva King Who Strikes Mountaintops, the bodhisattva Skillful Eloquence, the bodhisattva Ever-Outstretched Hand, the bodhisattva Earth-Holder, the bodhisattva Swift Eloquence, the bodhisattva Essence of Space, the bodhisattva Essence of the Moon, the bodhisattva Essence of the Sun, the bodhisattva Essence of the Stainless Moon, the bodhisattva Essence of the Solar Canopy —

the bodhisattva King of Supreme Distinction, the bodhisattva Great Sumeru, the bodhisattva Steadfast Intelligence, the bodhisattva Courageous Eloquence, and the bodhisattva great being Maitreya — these and others, sixty-two hundred thousand trillion bodhisattvas, spoke with one voice and said: "Blessed One, in the future age, at the very last of the five hundred periods, when the sacred Dharma is declining, we all wish to gather together and properly teach the dhāraṇī called Ratnatālā. Blessed One, please let it be so."

The Blessed One declared: "Excellent! Excellent, sons of good family! This is indeed difficult to do. Such a Dharma as this is exceedingly difficult to accomplish."

Then the Blessed One spoke thus to the bodhisattva Samantabhadra: "Son of good family, listen to the Ratnatālā dhāraṇī, which brings benefit to many beings and happiness to many beings."

The Blessed One then took his seat upon the great adorned lion throne and proclaimed the mantra: "Homage to all Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and fully awakened buddhas. Tadyathā: Oṃ maṃ, bharate bharate, bhara bharanate svāhā."

Then the Blessed One gave solemn utterance two and three times, saying: "Alalā — the Dharma! Alalā — the Dharma! Alalā — the Dharma!"

Thereupon the bodhisattva Samantabhadra addressed the Blessed One: "Blessed One, what is the underlying meaning of this word 'Dharma, Dharma'?"

The Blessed One declared: "Son of good family, the underlying meaning of all phenomena is the meaning of having no underlying ground. The underlying meaning of all phenomena is the meaning of having no underlying substantial thing. The underlying meaning of all phenomena is the underlying meaning of space. The underlying meaning of all phenomena is the underlying meaning of having nothing to be taken up. The underlying meaning of all phenomena is the underlying meaning of having nothing to be cast away."

Then Samantabhadra said: "Blessed One, then why are they called 'all phenomena'?"

The Blessed One declared: "Son of good family, what is called 'all phenomena' is this: the eye, the ear, the nose, the tongue, the body, and the mind — and likewise the elements (dhātus), the sense bases (āyatana), and dependent origination. Son of good family, this is what is called 'all phenomena.' Furthermore, son of good family, all phenomena are empty because from the very beginning they are unborn."

Then Mañjuśrī, the youthful prince, said to the bodhisattva Samantabhadra: "O son of the Victor, how is this Ratnatālā dhāraṇī to be held?"

When he had spoken, the bodhisattva Samantabhadra said to the youthful Mañjuśrī: "This dhāraṇī is to be held as the display of suchness — as the suchness of non-arising, as the suchness of non-occurrence, as the suchness without defining characteristics, as the suchness of space, as the suchness of having no substantial thing, as the suchness of essential nature, and as the suchness of the essential nature of having no substantial thing. Son of good family, the holding, the thorough holding, the cultivation, the analysis, the designation, the setting forth, the liberation, the differentiation, and the clarification of this Ratnatālā dhāraṇī are just as follows. Son of good family, this is the meaning of cultivating and thoroughly examining the Ratnatālā dhāraṇī."

Then the venerable Śāradvatīputra spoke to Mañjuśrī, the youthful, saying: "Mañjuśrī, how long have you been entered into this enumeration of the Dharma?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Śāradvatīputra, for as long as attachment, aversion, and delusion are capable of entering."

Śāradvatīputra said: "Son of good family, for as long as attachment, aversion, and delusion enter."

Mañjuśrī replied: "Śāradvatīputra, for as long as the earth element is capable of entering."

Śāradvatīputra said: "Son of good family, for as long as the earth element enters."

Mañjuśrī replied: "Śāradvatīputra, for as long as knowledge and ignorance are capable of entering."

Śāradvatīputra said: "Son of good family, for as long as knowledge and ignorance enter."

Mañjuśrī replied: "Śāradvatīputra, for as long as the space element is capable of entering."

Śāradvatīputra said: "Mañjuśrī, for as long as the space element enters."

Mañjuśrī replied: "Śāradvatīputra, for as long as all phenomena that have the essential nature of having no substantial thing are capable of entering."

Then the venerable Śāradvatīputra spoke to Mañjuśrī, the youthful, saying: "How could I possibly have the capacity to converse with such excellent persons as these? Son of good family, consider this example: not even all the dogs, cats, and foxes combined are capable of destroying Mount Meru, the king of mountains. Just so, Śāradvatīputra, when all the śrāvakas of this kind are not even capable of comprehending so much as one end of a single bodhisattva's teaching, what need is there to speak of the teaching of Mañjuśrī, the youthful?"

Then the bodhisattva Samantabhadra spoke to Mañjuśrī, the youthful, saying: "Mañjuśrī, please, when you depart, entreat the Tathāgata to protect and fully care for those Dharma-speakers who hold this king of sūtras in future times and future ages."

Then Mañjuśrī, the youthful, rose from his own Dharma-seat and addressed the Blessed One, saying: "Blessed One, please describe the particular qualities of those Dharma-speakers — the monks who hold, recite, thoroughly master, and widely and correctly teach this enumeration of the Dharma to others."

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, those monks who are Dharma-speakers holding this king of sūtras will assuredly arrive at my dharmakāya. They will attain the awakening of a buddha. They will draw close to the qualities of a buddha. Māra and the sons of the gods belonging to Māra's host who seek an opportunity will find no opportunity with them. Son of good family, as for those

who generate even a single thought of ill will toward such a Dharma-speaking monk, even to the extent of one moment of displeasure — they will be far removed from rebirth as a human being, to say nothing of the awakening of a buddha. Furthermore, Mañjuśrī, those who generate a thought of faithlessness toward the monks holding this king of sūtras will be born with bad teeth, will be born without a tongue or a nose, will be born with limbs turned outward, will be born with a body full of disease, will be born without eyes, will be born of a nature with impaired wisdom, and will be born with little diligence. Mañjuśrī, these are the faults of those undeluded persons. Mañjuśrī, to state it briefly, at the time of their death, in each and every one of their pores, immeasurable sufferings of the hell-beings will arise. And even if they are born as humans, they will be perpetually blind and will be born without a tongue."

"Mañjuśrī, furthermore, those who abandon this enumeration of the Dharma will, in this very lifetime, become leprous of body, will have lips that hang in a grotesque and frightful manner, will have a wasted body, will be naked of body, will have an emaciated body, and will come to resemble hungry ghosts (pretas).

Mañjuśrī, furthermore, the places where those undeluded persons will be reborn — these I know through the inconceivable, immeasurable wisdom of a buddha.

Mañjuśrī the youthful then requested: "May the Blessed One prophesy. May the Sugata prophesy."

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, do not ask about that in the slightest. The world together with its gods would become intoxicated with terror — they would be seized with fear, with dread, with utter dread."

Mañjuśrī said: "Out of compassionate concern, so that upon hearing this, these sentient beings may never again abandon the sacred Dharma henceforth, may the Blessed One please explain."

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, the hell-realms of sentient beings that exist beneath the earth bear these names: the Hot, the Extremely Hot, the Dark Spot, the All-Blazing, the Fiercely Blazing, the Hard to Touch, the Fierce, the Sharp-Lipped, the Iron Cauldron, the Iron Pestle, the Dark Pit, the Head-Crushing, the Spine-Pressing, the Monkey-Faced, the Ever-Blazing, the Putrid, the Ever-Foul-Smelling, the Utterly Crushing, the Crushed by That, and the Extremely Harm-Crushing. Mañjuśrī, these are the hell-realms of sentient beings where those undeluded persons will be reborn."

Then the bodhisattva Samantabhadra addressed the Blessed One thus: "Blessed One, where will those who teach the Dharma be reborn after they pass from here and die?"

The Blessed One declared: "Samantabhadra, you have asked well. Samantabhadra, a son of good family or daughter of good family who teaches the Dharma, upon passing from here and dying, will be reborn in the buddha-field of the Tathāgata of Inconceivable Eloquence — a world-system of exquisite adornment in which every single bodhisattva is utterly beautiful. At the time of death, that son of good family will come face to face with one hundred and twenty billion buddhas. Briefly, Samantabhadra, the merits of that son of good family are beyond count, beyond measure — they cannot be expressed even in a thousand aeons.

The bodhisattva Samantabhadra then asked: "Blessed One, in a future time, in a future age, what manner of sentient beings will arise who will abandon this enumeration of the Dharma?"

The Blessed One declared: "Samantabhadra, those sentient beings who will abandon these Dharma teachings will for the most part be those who have gone forth into renunciation. They will proclaim such things as: 'These are compositions of poetry and are not what the Tathāgata taught. These are fabrications of our own making. These sūtras have never been heard before.' Speaking thus, they will abandon this enumeration of the Dharma. And having abandoned it, they will not confess or repent. Because they have abandoned the Dharma, at the time of death they will be reborn in the hell-realm of All-Blazing, burning intolerably. The moment they are born there, iron wheels will sever the heads of those undeluded persons and cast them to the ground. And having undergone that, for many aeons — for many hundreds of aeons, for many thousands of aeons — they will be born blind."

And even if, after a hundred aeons have passed, they are reborn as human beings, in every one of those lives they will be born blind, tongueless, with faces turned sideways, hunchbacked, with sunken necks, lame, with voices like the barking of dogs, constantly afflicted by hunger and thirst, with withered bodies and foul breath — and whenever any sentient being sees or hears them, they will be born repulsive and disagreeable.

Then that entire assembly spoke with one voice: "Blessed One, we confess and repent our transgression in having abandoned sūtras of this kind and in having looked upon those who teach the Dharma with minds of anger. Blessed One,

we confess and repent however childish we have been, however confused, however deficient in wisdom, however small in understanding. May the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, take this to heart."

Then those great śrāvakas, together with Śakra (Indra, king of the gods), Brahmā, the world-guardians, the monks, the nuns, the laymen, and the laywomen, were filled with awe and said: "Blessed One, we are utterly awestruck upon hearing a teaching such as this."

The Blessed One declared: "Friends, it is indeed so, just as has been said. You have good cause to be frightened. Friends, if even I, who have attained the wisdom of omniscience, am frightened, what need is there to speak of those who are my disciples? Sons of good family, this Dharma is profound. Since no human being, non-human, god, nāga, yakṣa (Skt. yakṣa), or gandharva (Skt. gandharva) is able to disturb it, how much less could other ascetics or brahmins? Sons of good family, this enumeration of the Dharma has become a stūpa worthy of veneration by the world together with its gods. Sons of good family, just as one should regard the precious casket of the Three Jewels, so too should one regard this king of sūtras."

Then the youthful Mañjuśrī addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, this has been well said. Blessed One, how will monks such as those fully consume the merit of what they have given with faith?"

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, those who abandon this enumeration of the Dharma and who generate an unloving mind toward those who teach the Dharma — I do not allow that they may fully consume even a single day's gift given with faith, or even so much as a single gift of a mere sesame seed, or even a single spit on a piece of ground offered to the Saṅgha."

Then the venerable Śāradvatīputra addressed the Blessed One thus: "Blessed One, are the five acts of immediate retribution (Skt. ānantarya) near to this, or are they far?"

The Blessed One declared: "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, do not ask in that way. Why is this? Śāradvatīputra, the five acts of immediate retribution are never the same as abandoning this supreme enumeration of the Dharma. One who commits the five acts of immediate retribution will, once those five acts are quickly exhausted, be reborn as a human being. But a person who abandons the holy Dharma will never attain the qualities of a buddha. Such a one destroys himself and destroys others as well."

Then the venerable Śāradvatīputra, in the presence of the Blessed One, wept and said: "Alas, how pitiful are those sentient beings who abandon the holy Dharma. May I never see, even in a dream, karmic obscurations such as these."

The third fascicle.

Then the Blessed One spoke thus to the venerable Śāradvatīputra: "Śāradvatīputra, do not think this: that the Dharma I have taught is conditional upon arising, and that the world is owned by karma, that beings partake of the share of their own karma, and that karma is what sustains them — that sentient beings experience feelings of suffering through their own respective karmas, and that the Tathāgata bears no responsibility for that. Śāradvatīputra, I have taught the path that leads to the good and the wholesome: the path that leads to happiness, the path that leads to fearlessness, the path that leads to the passing beyond sorrow, and the path that leads to the deathless. And yet these sentient beings are possessed of misconduct in body, possessed of misconduct in speech, and possessed of misconduct in mind; they disparage the noble ones and hold wrong views. It is on account of karma rooted in wrong views and the abandonment of the true Dharma that, when their bodies perish and they die, they are born in the states of misfortune, the evil destinies, the places of ruin — in the hells. For that, the Tathāgata bears no responsibility.

Śāradvatīputra, such compassion as this arises in me toward all sentient beings: 'Rather than abandon even a single sentient being, I would myself experience the sufferings of the hells for an aeon, or even longer than an aeon, for the sake of that one being.' Śāradvatīputra, such is the great compassion of the Tathāgata.

Śāradvatīputra, consider this analogy. Suppose a person has a single child, beautiful and lovely in form, pleasing to behold, possessed of a fine and lustrous complexion, the most excellent of all. If that child, through some adverse condition, comes to die, the parent, thinking of the child, is overcome with grief and distress, and weeps and laments. Śāradvatīputra, in exactly the same way, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened Buddha, regards sentient beings who are suffering as though they were his only child. Yet the Tathāgatas do not dwell together with afflictions.

Śāradvatīputra, consider this analogy: the great ocean does not abide together with a corpse. Śāradvatīputra, in exactly the same way, the Tathāgatas do not

dwell together with afflictions.

Śāradvatīputra, consider this analogy: a skilled magician, or the skilled student of a magician, conjures up before a great crowd of people at a crossroads in a broad highway a great variety of figures and displays various actions — and yet those actions do not abide in any place or any direction; they are neither born nor ceased, nor will they cease. Śāradvatīputra, in exactly the same way, the Tathāgatas, while bringing sentient beings to full maturation and even displaying conduct associated with desire, display such performances — and yet those conducts do not truly exist. Just as the element of space is free of conceptuality and free of conceptual elaboration, so too the body of the Tathāgata is free of conceptuality and free of conceptual elaboration. Yet the Tathāgatas adapt themselves in accordance with sentient beings, and they engage in whatever way will serve to tame those sentient beings.

Śāradvatīputra, in the Tathāgata there is no error. In the Tathāgata there is no unknowing. In the Tathāgata there is no forgetfulness.

Śāradvatīputra, I am the foremost, the chief, the best, the highest, the most excellent, the supreme, the unexcelled, the unsurpassed, the incomparably equal of the world together with its gods. Śāradvatīputra, this statement is in accord with truth. Whether one has gone forth from home life or whether one is a householder —"

All those sentient beings who abandon this enumeration of Dharma will encounter sufferings such as these in the hells.

Then the venerable Subhūti, having heard this teaching of the Blessed One, joined his palms together and addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, those sentient beings have found a finding that is no finding at all. Those who would abandon this enumeration of Dharma — what will their tongues become?"

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, their tongues will become a hundred thousand leagues in length. Upon those tongues, blazing iron ploughshares — burning, utterly aflame, blazing on every side, spreading and burning, their flames merged into one — will furrow them five billion times. And why is this? It is because those beings did not guard their speech. Subhūti, such will be the karmic obscuration of those unwise ones."

Then the entire retinue, endowed with the power of the Buddha, proclaimed aloud again and again: "Wondrous and magnificent is what the Tathāgata has

taught!"

Then Śakra, lord of the gods (Indra, king of the heavenly realm), spoke these words to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I shall honor those monks who teach the Dharma upon their shoulders. I shall make offerings to them with flowers, incense, perfume, garlands, and unguents. I shall hold a canopy over them three times and bow three times at every mark. I shall pay homage to them. I shall show them reverence. I shall regard them as my superiors. I shall draw their likeness. I shall make offerings to them. I shall venerate them. I shall supplicate them. I shall revere them, regard them as my superiors, and guard them with devotion. And why is this? Because they are children of the Blessed One, born from the dharmakāya, the truth body.

"Blessed One, consider, for example, a son born of a kṣatriya king who has been consecrated by the anointing of the crown — handsome, beautiful, and lovely to behold. He is worthy of the offerings and homage of all those beneath him. Just so, those who teach the Dharma are likewise worthy of the offerings and homage of the world together with its gods."

Then the Blessed One spoke these words to the bodhisattva Samantabhadra: "Noble son, Śakra, lord of the gods, has spoken well in saying that those monks who teach the Dharma should be cherished in one's heart, fully protected, guarded on all sides, and sheltered."

The bodhisattva Samantabhadra then said: "Blessed One, I too shall guard, fully protect, fully uphold, and bring to peace and well-being those sons of noble family and daughters of noble family. I shall fully protect them within a circle of a hundred leagues all around."

Then the Blessed One gave the bodhisattva Samantabhadra his approval, saying: "Excellent! Excellent, noble son, that you have spoken these words so well!"

Then the Blessed One, in a voice like that of Brahmā, proclaimed these verses:

You who have gathered that which brings benefit and happiness to others,
supremely beautiful in your many aspects, possessed of the highest speech,
utterly pure, bearing good form, your aspiration the most excellent —
you have spoken well the verse that is the peerless peer of precious qualities.

Then the bodhisattva Samantabhadra addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, if bodhisattvas, great beings, possess a single quality, will they obtain the dhāraṇī of the precious tāla tree?"

The Blessed One declared: "Noble son, if bodhisattvas, great beings, possess a single quality, they will obtain the dhāraṇī of the precious tāla tree."

"What is that single quality? It is this: having no anger toward any sentient being."

"Samantabhadra, there are two qualities for bodhisattvas, great beings. What are those two? They are: freedom from jealousy, and freedom from conceit. Samantabhadra, these are the two qualities of bodhisattvas, great beings."

"Samantabhadra, furthermore, a bodhisattva, a great being, will cause no harm to the faculties of any sentient being. Noble son, furthermore, a bodhisattva must not, in any way whatsoever, give rise to hostility toward any sentient being in any respect at all."

When this exposition of the qualities of bodhisattvas was taught, and when the distinctive qualities of the dhāraṇī of the precious tāla tree were fully set forth and proclaimed, immeasurable numbers of sentient beings among gods and humans obtained the dhāraṇī. This concludes the chapter on the full proclamation of the distinctive qualities of the dhāraṇī of the precious tāla tree.

Then the venerable Ānanda rose from his seat, arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee on the ground, bowed with palms joined in the direction of the Blessed One, and addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, this enumeration of the Dharma is profound."

The Blessed One declared: "Ānanda, it is indeed so. It is profound because form is profound. It is profound because feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are profound. It is profound because emptiness is profound. It is profound because space is profound."

Ānanda said: "Blessed One, though I have heard the eighty-four thousand aggregates of Dharma directly from the Tathāgata, I have never before heard an enumeration of the Dharma such as this."

The Blessed One declared: "This enumeration of the Dharma is exceedingly difficult to hear."

Ānanda said: "Blessed One, please bestow your blessing upon this enumeration of the Dharma, so that in the future, in the last of the five hundred years, in the age when the sacred Dharma is declining, it may perform the deeds of a buddha for many sentient beings."

The Blessed One declared: "Ānanda, I have already blessed this enumeration of the Dharma, and I, Śākyamuni Tathāgata, have also blessed those who teach the Dharma. Ānanda, whoever writes down this enumeration of the Dharma will not suffer from disease of the eyes, disease of the tongue, disease of the nose, disease of the teeth, disease of the hands and feet, disease of the brain, disease of the ears. Their body will not be diminished. Their body will not have an unpleasant smell. They will not die before their time through harm inflicted by others. All humans and non-humans will become their protectors. When they pass away from this life, having completely abandoned all conceptual elaboration, they will be born among the gods in the higher realms, in the worlds of the fortunate destinies."

Ānanda asked: "Blessed One, what is the cause, what is the condition, for māras not creating obstacles when this Dharma is being taught?"

The Blessed One declared: "Ānanda, no māra whatsoever is capable of creating an obstacle to this enumeration of the Dharma. Ānanda, at the very moment when the evil māra forms the thought, 'I shall go and create an obstacle to the teaching of the dhāraṇī of the precious tāla tree,' at that very moment the evil māra sees his own dwelling blazing all around. Ānanda, so profound is this enumeration of the Dharma. Ānanda, whatever region and place where this enumeration of the Dharma is practiced, that place itself becomes a stūpa, and becomes an object worthy of veneration."

Ānanda said: "Blessed One, if the Tathāgata himself were dwelling in a particular region and place, and this enumeration of the Dharma were also present in that very place —"

"I have come to behold the Tathāgata, and having come, if I first pay homage to the Tathāgata and then afterward pay homage to this enumeration of the Dharma, what fault is there in that?"

The Blessed One declared: "Ānanda, at the very moment when you employ this enumeration of the Dharma in such a way and bow down to me, at that moment you will be at fault. Ānanda, furthermore, although I am the highest, the chief, the supreme, and the most excellent among all the worlds with their gods, Ānanda, it was by first hearing this enumeration of the Dharma that I afterward fully and perfectly awoke to complete awakening."

Ānanda asked: "Blessed One, before whom was it that the Tathāgata heard this teaching — the Tathāgata's Precious Jewel of the Tāla Tree, the meditative absorption thus revealed?"

The Blessed One declared: "Ānanda, among the worlds of humans, the worlds of gods, and the worlds of gandharvas (celestial musicians), there is no one above me. However, while I was practicing the conduct of a bodhisattva, I heard this teaching directly from the Blessed One, the Tathāgata whose wisdom is unobstructed — the Stacked Essence, the Radiance of Excellence, the Center of Innumerable Inconceivable Rays of Light — and Ānanda, having passed through many tens of billions of kalpas of great and difficult deeds, I heard this enumeration of the Dharma, and at that time that Tathāgata gave me a prophecy. Ānanda, therefore you should first pay homage to this enumeration of the Dharma, and afterward bow down to me."

Then Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods), Brahmā, and all those world-protectors together with one voice spoke these words: "Aho! The Dharma! Aho! The Dharma! How wondrous is the magical display of phenomena!" "Even those sentient beings who merely hear the name of this enumeration of the Dharma are worthy of veneration — how much more so those who hold it, read it, make it thoroughly their own, and teach it extensively and correctly to others. Such beings should be called Tathāgatas."

Then the Blessed One spoke to Śakra, Brahmā, and those world-protectors: "Well done, well done, friends! You have spoken these words well."

Then from the mouth of the Blessed One the glorious tongue emerged, and illuminating the entire great trichiliocosm with that tongue, the Blessed One addressed the bodhisattva Samantabhadra as follows: "Those sentient beings who do not hear this enumeration of the Dharma are like a person born blind who cannot see the light of the sun, like a merchant who does not know his methods, and like a poor person dependent on others for his very sustenance. For their sake I have offered these examples, so that sentient beings may never be separated from this precious mass of Dharma. For the sake of this enumeration of the Dharma and for the benefit of all sentient beings I make this request of you, noble son — are you willing?"

Then the bodhisattva Samantabhadra rose from his seat, draped his outer robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee on the ground, joined his palms toward the Blessed One and bowed in that direction, and wept. At the very moment that the bodhisattva Samantabhadra rose from his Dharma seat, instantly the great trichiliocosm trembled in six ways: it swayed, greatly swayed, and swayed all around; it shook, greatly shook, and shook all around; it rocked, greatly rocked, and rocked all around; it rumbled, greatly rumbled,

and rumbled all around; it resounded, greatly resounded, and resounded all around; it was stirred, greatly stirred, and stirred all around. And a great light arose throughout the world.

Then the bodhisattva Samantabhadra, with all ten fingers joined in reverence, wept and addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, I am glad. Sugata, I am glad. Blessed One, you are omniscient, you wish benefit for all sentient beings, and you are possessed of great compassion — and yet, though I am born of the Tathāgata, why do I not act in accordance with the Tathāgata's word? Blessed One, the Tathāgata's word is a word of nectar. Where then would I find the power to act contrary to the Tathāgata's word? Blessed One, I shall make amends for what has been done. I will not fail to make amends for what has been done."

Then the Blessed One gave the bodhisattva Samantabhadra his approval, saying "Excellent!" and declared: "O son of the Victor, excellent, excellent! You are the eldest son of the Tathāgatas, their chief, supreme, noble, and foremost. This compendium of Dharma I now entrust entirely to you. It is my Teacher — therefore you must guard it. At regular intervals pay it reverence. Place it in a jeweled vessel and carry it upon your shoulder. In future times, in future ages, do not place your trust in those monks who are evildoers. O son of good family, this is now transmitted to you."

The bodhisattva Samantabhadra asked: "Blessed One, what kind of monks will appear in those times?"

The Blessed One replied: "O son of good family, do not ask about that now."

The bodhisattva Samantabhadra said: "It will serve as medicine for many sentient beings. Blessed One, please explain. Sugata, please explain."

The Blessed One declared: "Samantabhadra, listen carefully. Let this ocean-like assembly here present, together with Mañjuśrī, Avalokiteśvara the Mighty, and all the innumerable and immeasurable great bodhisattvas — let them set aside other matters and attend. Listen now to what kinds of monks will appear in future times, in future ages."

Then the Blessed One addressed the bodhisattva Samantabhadra in these words: "Samantabhadra, there will appear monks who undermine the sacred Dharma, who are attached to household life, attached to material gain, attached to temples, attached to dwelling places, attached to their bowl and robes, who trouble households, and who engage in all manner of evil conduct.

Samantabhadra, it is for those who lack discernment that I am entrusting this sūtra — may this sūtra not disappear!"

Then from all ten directions gods (devas), nāgas, yakṣas, and gandharvas all assembled and addressed the Blessed One thus: "Blessed One, we too have all gathered and come together. For as long as we live, and for as long as the sacred Dharma endures, we will maintain and uphold this compendium of Dharma. We will also maintain and uphold those monks who teach the Dharma. We will pay them reverence. We will honor them. We will pay them homage. We will make offerings to them. We will venerate them. We will provide for their needs."

Then the Blessed One spoke these verses of exhortation to the bodhisattva Samantabhadra and the other nine hundred and twenty-two million bodhisattvas:

"Hear from me the full account of all the qualities
of those who have perfected virtue and gone to the other shore —

Abandon arrogance, pride, and heedlessness,
and listen with a glad and joyful mind.

Here in Magadha, beside the lord of trees at the seat of awakening,
dwells the self-arisen lion among men, as he is renowned.

He rests in the supreme meditative absorption of liberation,
dwelling at the foot of that great king of trees.

Equal in number to the dust-motes of the fields in all ten directions,
noble and excellent beings surround him as heroes.

The meditative absorption called the Vast Buddha Samādhi —
in that very absorption the lord of men abides.

The lord of men, having entered and understood that equipoise,
and from the eastern direction Mañjuśrī, the youthful one,
together with noble and excellent beings equal to the dust-motes
of ten buddha-fields, came into the Victor's presence.

In the same way, from the fields of all ten directions,
all those known as Śrī, sons of the buddha,
together with noble and excellent beings equal to the dust-motes
of the fields of all ten directions, arrived together.

Having thus assembled, those who wished to bring benefit to the world
addressed those endowed with the boundless renown of Mañjuśrī,
asking of Śrī of Noble Excellence:

what is the conduct and what are the qualities of the sons of the buddha?

Then the bodhisattva named Mañjuśrī,
unstained, and dwelling in the pure domain of practice
endowed with the qualities of awakening and the qualities of joyful breadth,
addressed Śrī of Noble Excellence in reply.

The Victor supports me in speaking here
of the pure domain of the sons of the buddha.
You too should declare what are the qualities
and what is the conduct of the sons of the buddha.

Śrī of Noble Excellence spoke: Sons of the Victor, listen.
Of the qualities of that one endowed with boundless qualities,
I will set forth just a small portion by way of example,
as meager as a drop in the ocean.

The arising of a self-originated mind directed toward awakening,
which has become the very ground of that awakening —
when generated for the very first time,
the praise of its qualities is without limit;
not even one with no equal could fully recount them.

What then need be said of the qualities of the perfections and the grounds,
practiced across many eons?

Even all the Victors of the ten directions
could not exhaust the river of those qualities in the telling.

Of the qualities of those who possess boundless qualities,
I shall speak just a small portion by way of example,
comparable to the track of a bird in the sky,
or to a single speck of dust from all the great continents.

The arising of that mind directed toward the ground of awakening's qualities
is not without cause — it comes about as follows:

generating faith in the Victor, the Dharma of the Victor, and the Saṅgha,
with clarity and pure devotion, that mind arises.

It arises not for the sake of desire, enjoyment, royal dominion,
pleasure for oneself, fame, or renown.

It arises as the mind that wishes to bring benefit to the world,
for the purpose of pacifying without exception all the suffering of beings.

It arises to perpetually benefit sentient beings,
to purify the fields, to make offerings to the buddhas,
to hold the Dharma in its entirety, to attain the awakening of a buddha,
and to purify primordial wisdom — for these purposes that mind arises.

Ever maintaining faith in all the Victors, in the Dharma, and likewise
in the community of noble ones,
generating pure clarity, aspiration, and profound respect,
and in order to honor one's teacher with reverence — that mind arises.

Having developed faith in the Victor and the Dharma of the Victor,
and faith in the conduct of the sons of the buddha,
and having developed faith in unsurpassed awakening,
in the minds of the great ones that mind arises.

Those who have become masters of themselves through the power of faith,
making offerings with inconceivable and vast acts of veneration,
and offering similarly inconceivable offerings to the Dharma
and to the undivided Saṅgha — from these, that mind arises.

Faith, like a leading mother, generates all qualities,
guards and causes them to increase.
It dispels doubt and delivers one from the rivers.
Faith is the emblem of the city of happiness.

Faith is clear and unstained, and brightens the mind.
It abandons arrogance and is the root of reverence.
Faith is the supreme treasury, wealth, and foundation.

Faith is the root, like a hand, for gathering virtue.
Faith delights in giving completely.
Faith generates deep joy in the Dharma of the Victors.
Faith distinguishes the excellence of qualities and gnosis.
It reveals the rank of buddhahood and enables its attainment.
It sharpens the faculties and makes them brilliantly clear.
The power of faith cannot be stolen away by others,
and it is the ground and support for dispelling afflictions.

Faith, arising from within, seeks to purify all qualities.
Faith holds no attachment to the doorways of attachment.
It abandons the absence of leisure and is the single supreme leisure.
Faith crosses beyond the path of māra

and reveals the supreme path of liberation.

The undecayed seed of the field of qualities —

faith brings forth the field of awakening.

It causes the excellence of gnosis and qualities to grow.

Faith is what reveals all the Victors.

Those who have the distinctive, joyous devotion born of faith —

their conduct will be described in due order.

Such Dharma as this is exceedingly rare in the world,

like a jewel-king within the ocean.

Those who always have faith and reverence toward the buddhas

do not abandon the training of moral discipline.

Those who do not abandon the training of moral discipline —

the one endowed with qualities praises them as endowed with qualities.

Moral discipline reveals the awakening mind

and connects one to the qualities of the stages of training.

Those who do not abandon the training of moral discipline

become worthy of being praised by the Victors.

Those who always have faith and reverence toward the buddhas

make vast offerings to the Victors.

Those who make great offerings to the Victors

have inconceivable faith in the buddhas.

Those who always have faith and reverence in the Dharma

are never sated with hearing the Dharma from the Victors.

Those who are never sated with hearing the Dharma of the Victors

have inconceivable devotion to the Dharma.

Those who always have faith and reverence toward the Saṅgha

have faith in the Saṅgha that does not turn back.

Those who have unsurpassed faith in the Saṅgha that does not turn back

themselves become irreversible through the power of faith.

Those who are irreversible through the power of faith

have faculties that are sharp and brilliantly clear.

Those whose faculties are sharp and brilliantly clear

completely abandon companions of wrong conduct.

Those who completely abandon companions of wrong conduct

are thoroughly taken up by companions endowed with Dharma.

Those who are thoroughly taken up by companions endowed with Dharma
accumulate vast virtue.

Those who accumulate vast virtue

are great beings who are endowed with the power of causes.

Those who are great beings endowed with the power of causes
come to have vast and distinctive devotion.

Those who have vast and distinctive devotion
are always blessed by all the Victors.

Those who are always blessed by all the Victors
give rise to the mind aimed at awakening.

Those in whom the mind aimed at awakening has arisen
strive for the qualities of the great sages (ṛṣis).

Those who strive for the qualities of the great sages
are born into a high lineage, the lineage of the buddhas.

Those who are born into a high lineage, the lineage of the buddhas,
remain in evenness, abandoning what to engage and what not to engage.

Those who abandon what to engage and what not to engage
have purified faith and intention.

Those who have purified faith and intention
possess the supreme elevated and excellent aspiration.

Those who possess the supreme elevated and excellent aspiration
constantly practice the perfections.

Those who constantly practice the perfections
have entered this Great Vehicle.

Those who have entered this Great Vehicle
venerate the buddhas through accomplishment.

Those who venerate the buddhas through accomplishment
never sever their mindful recollection of the buddhas.

Those who never sever their mindful recollection of the buddhas
always see the immeasurable buddhas.

Those who always see the immeasurable buddhas —
among them, the buddhas are never absent.

Those among whom the buddhas are never absent
never decline from the Dharma in the intervening moments.

Those who never decline from the Dharma in the intervening moments
gain confidence that is free from all obscuration.

Those who gain confidence free from all obscuration
teach the Dharma supremely and without limit.
Those who teach the Dharma supremely and without limit
cherish all beings with loving-kindness and wish them benefit.
Those who cherish all beings with loving-kindness and wish them benefit
have a firm root of great compassion.
Those who have a firm root of great compassion
become lords of joy, delighting in the Dharma.
Those who are lords of joy, delighting in the Dharma,
have utterly cast aside the faults of conditioned existence.
Those who have utterly cast aside the faults of conditioned existence
are free from pride and arrogance and are never heedless.
Those who are free from pride and arrogance and are never heedless
strive constantly for the welfare of both self and others.
Those who strive constantly for the welfare of both self and others
feel no weariness at all toward saṃsāra.
Those who feel no weariness at all toward saṃsāra
are endowed with the supreme and excellent spiritual nourishment.
Those who are endowed with the supreme and excellent spiritual nourishment
give rise to pure and limpid higher knowledge.
Those who give rise to pure and limpid higher knowledge
comprehend the many modes of conduct of all beings.
Those who comprehend the many modes of conduct of all beings
are skilled in ripening beings to full maturation.
Those who are skilled in ripening beings to full maturation
are adept in the rites of gathering beings together.
Those who are adept in the rites of gathering beings together
apply themselves to the four means of gathering disciples.
Those who apply themselves to the four means of gathering disciples
accomplish benefit for beings without limit.
Those who accomplish benefit for beings without limit
are grounded in wisdom and skillful means.
Those heroes who are grounded in wisdom and skillful means
abide on the unsurpassed path.
Those heroes who abide on the unsurpassed path
cannot be overwhelmed by the armies of māra.
Those who cannot be overwhelmed by the armies of māra

have utterly transcended the path of māra.
Those who have utterly transcended the path of māra
in turn attain the stage of non-retrogression.
Those who attain the stage of non-retrogression
have obtained the acceptance of non-arising.
Those who have obtained the acceptance of non-arising
are lights of the world, prophesied by the Victors.
Those lights of the world who are prophesied by the Victors
dwell face to face with all the Victors.
Those who dwell face to face with all the Victors
are skilled in the rites of the secret emanations of the Victors.
Those who are skilled in the rites of the secret emanations of the Victors
are held in mind by all the Victors.
Those who are held in mind by all the Victors
are beautifully adorned with every excellence and quality.
Those who are beautifully adorned with every excellence and quality
have purified even their bodies through supreme merit.
Those whose bodies are thus purified through supreme merit
blaze like mountains of gold.
Those who blaze like mountains of gold
are perfect in the thirty-two major marks.
Those who are perfect in the thirty-two major marks
adorn their bodies with the excellent minor marks.
Those who adorn their bodies with the excellent minor marks
radiate boundless light from their bodies.
Those who radiate boundless light from their bodies
send forth arrays of rays beyond all thought.
Those from whose rays of light lotuses spring forth
display the Victor's form seated upon a lotus throne
throughout the pure worlds of the ten directions,
and, abiding purposefully, tame sentient beings.
Those who display the Victor's form seated upon a lotus throne
throughout the pure worlds of the ten directions,
and, abiding purposefully, tame sentient beings —
their higher knowledge and magical displays are without limit.
Those whose higher knowledge and magical displays are without limit
are themselves inconceivable and roam through the inconceivable,

teaching Dharma phenomena that are beyond all thought.

and satisfy sentient beings beyond all thought.

Those who teach Dharma phenomena beyond all thought

and satisfy sentient beings beyond all thought —

through the power of their individual discriminating wisdom,

they tame the sentient beings of the world according to their intentions.

Those who through the power of their individual discriminating wisdom

tame the sentient beings of the world according to their intentions —

their body, speech, and mind are forever

preceded by wisdom and followed by wisdom.

Those whose body, speech, and mind are forever

preceded by wisdom and followed by wisdom —

through the power of aspiration, wherever it is wished,

they display form within the stream of sentient beings.

Those who through the power of aspiration, wherever it is wished,

display form within the stream of sentient beings —

when they utter words,

sounds arise with countless melodious qualities.

Those from whom, when they utter words,

sounds arise with countless melodious qualities —

they know in a single moment, with their mind,

the minds of all beings without exception.

Those who know in a single moment, with their mind,

the minds of all beings without exception —

they never die, are never born, and never change;

nor does the arising of wandering afflictions occur for them.

Those who never die, are never born,

and for whom the arising of wandering afflictions does not occur —

their body is the gnosis of qualities and dharmatā;

distinguished by the Dharma, they move through the world.

Those whose body is the gnosis of qualities and dharmatā,

and who, distinguished by the Dharma, move through the world —

they abide in the ten grounds, the ten masteries,

the perfections, and the supreme liberations.

Those who abide in the ten grounds, the ten masteries,

the perfections, and the supreme liberations —

they subsequently attain empowerment and its arrangements, magical display,

and abiding in the supreme meditative absorption.

Those who subsequently attain empowerment and its arrangements, magical display,

and abiding in the supreme meditative absorption —

they receive, without exception, every empowerment from all the Victors of the ten directions.

Those who receive, without exception, every empowerment from all the Victors of the ten directions —

upon their crowns the buddhas of the ten directions confer empowerment with the nectar held in the palms of their hands.

Those upon whose crowns the buddhas of the ten directions confer empowerment with the nectar held in the palms of their hands — steadfast in their might, like the sky,

they pervade all without exception and dwell in every direction.

Those who are steadfast in their might and, like the sky, pervade all without exception and dwell in every direction — these matchless ones move in a domain that the worlds, together with their gods, are unable to fathom.

Those matchless ones who move in a domain that the worlds, together with their gods, are unable to fathom — their approach, their sight, their name when heard, and their confident speech are all meaningful.

Those whose approach, whose sight, whose name when heard, and whose confident speech are all meaningful — these great beings give generosity, and every gift they give becomes meaningful.

Through the power of these excellent persons, the Dharma endures and loving-kindness does not diminish; virtuous actions come to be widely practiced, and the power of the Three Jewels rises to the highest excellence.

Just as there exists a supreme jewel of hard vajra, whose power causes the jewels in the ocean to be inexhaustible, unfading, and without increase — so too the water of qualities with boundless qualities: in whatever realm there is no buddha,

it reveals the full awakening of enlightenment;
in whatever direction there is no Dharma,
it reveals the treasury of the Dharma.

They are free of conceptuality and discursive thought,
and, accomplishing all effortlessly, in every direction
they manifest resplendently, like the moon,
and tame sentient beings by a thousand skillful means.
In each and every moment, throughout all the worlds
of the ten directions, they reveal awakening and buddhahood.

They show the heroes turning the wheel of Dharma, passing into nirvāṇa, and
the wide-spreading of relics. Those skilled ones display, at the stages of
śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, the inconceivable emanations of
buddha-realms across incalculable eons, taming sentient beings through the
gateway of the three vehicles. Those who understand the accomplishments of
every aspiration display the forms of boys, girls, and women, of gods, humans,
asuras, nāgas, and yakṣas, of the great serpents (nāgas in their great coiled
form), and the bodies of the mighty sea-serpents. Through the samādhi of the
Ocean Seal (Skt. Sāgaramudrā), those heroes display, without remainder, all
the department, forms, and modes of being of wandering beings, together
with all their signs, conduct, sounds, and speech.

Those whose arrangement of pure realms is inconceivable make offerings to
all the Victors of the ten directions. Those who, through inconceivable pure
realms, make offerings to all the Victors of the ten directions — their arranged
rays of light are immeasurable, and their wisdom that illuminates sentient
beings is boundless.

Those whose arranged rays of light are immeasurable and whose wisdom that
illuminates sentient beings is immeasurable — their emanations of body and
speech are inconceivable, and their emanations of mind are inconceivable.

Those whose emanations of body, speech, and mind are inconceivable — their
inconceivable emanations of generosity and moral discipline, their
inconceivable emanations of patience and diligence, are beyond reckoning.

Those whose inconceivable emanations of generosity, moral discipline,
patience, and diligence are beyond reckoning — through the samādhi of the
Flower Ornament of the Buddhas (Skt. Buddhāvataṃsaka), their inconceivable
emanations of meditative concentration, wisdom, skillful means, and higher

knowledge, and their emanations of every quality, are entirely boundless.

Those who, through the samādhi of entering into the finest particles, accomplish their presence in every particle — on a single particle they display inconceivable pure realms, yet in the particle itself there is no increase. On that very particle they display some realms adorned with buddhas and some without buddhas; some purified of afflictions, some dense; some vast, some subtle, some great. Some realms are shown in formation and in dissolution, some are shown as level and aligned, some appear like a mirage of still, clear water, and some appear as though illusions of the eye. Just as they display all this upon a single particle, so too they display it without remainder upon every particle. Such is the emanation of samādhi of the great seers (Skt. ṛṣi), and such is this liberation of boundless renown.

Those who, through the samādhi of the emanation of royal offering, accomplish their presence before all the Victors — filling the great three-thousandfold world system in the palm of the hand, they make offerings to the great beings. From every direction, garlands of flowers, perfumes and unguents, and however many precious things there are — these they release from the palm of the hand as offerings to the Victors seated at the foot of the awakening tree.

Robes, powders, and however many precious things there are, victory banners, pennants, the finest and most varied parasols, and precious canopies adorned with gold — all these they rain down in showers from the palm of the hand.

In all ten directions, whatever limitless offerings and implements are fit for the great seers — these they pour as rain from the palm of the hand and make offerings to the Victors seated at the foot of the awakening tree.

Whatever music there is in all directions — drums, clay drums, melodious lutes, sweet-sounding cymbals, great-sounding flutes — all these they cause to resound in full from the palm of the hand.

The varied and genuine praises of the qualities of the peerless ones of all the ten directions, and the varied accomplished verses of eulogy — all these they cause to resound in full from the palm of the hand.

The merit entirely accumulated from whatever rays of light — this they dispense in full from the right hand, and

They pour perfumed water throughout all the Victor's pure lands and make offerings to the lamps of the world. With beautifully arranged rays of light, lovely and resplendent, with garlands of lotus ornaments beyond reckoning freely hanging, and with many lotus forms bearing the most excellent of marks — from their palms they make offerings to the Victors.

With abundant flowers, with the most excellent of flowers, scattering rays of light arranged in flowers, spreading varied flowers everywhere — as great beings they make offering to those Victors.

With abundant incense, with the most excellent of incenses, scattering rays of light arranged in incense, spreading varied incenses everywhere — as great beings they make offering to those Victors.

With abundant perfumed substances, with the most excellent of perfumes, scattering rays of light arranged in perfume, spreading varied perfumes everywhere — as great beings they make offering to those Victors.

With abundant garlands, with the most excellent of garlands, scattering rays of light arranged in garlands, spreading varied garlands everywhere — as great beings they make offering to those Victors.

With abundant powders, with the most excellent of powders, scattering rays of light arranged in powders, spreading varied powders everywhere — as great beings they make offering to those Victors.

With abundant robes, with the most excellent of robes, scattering rays of light arranged in robes, spreading varied robes everywhere — as great beings they make offering to those Victors.

With abundant parasols, with the most excellent of parasols, scattering rays of light arranged in parasols, spreading varied parasols everywhere — as great beings they make offering to those Victors.

With abundant jewels, with the most excellent of jewels, scattering rays of light arranged in jewels, spreading varied jewels everywhere — as great beings they make offering to those Victors.

With abundant lotuses, with the most excellent of lotuses, scattering rays of light arranged in lotuses, spreading varied lotuses everywhere — as great beings they make offering to those Victors.

With abundant ornamental garlands, with the most excellent of ornamental garlands, scattering rays of light arranged in ornamental garlands, spreading

varied ornamental garlands everywhere — as great beings they make offering to those Victors.

Scattering the most excellent array of victory banners in rays of light — those victory banners of white, red, and yellow, of blue, and varied arrangements of victory banners — with their multitudes they adorn all the pure lands of the Victors.

Parasols arrayed with various jewel-like ornaments, with silken streamers and banners beautifully unfurled, with swaying net-curtains of bells proclaiming the speech of the Victors — these they hold above the heads of the Tathāgatas.

Such are the boundless offerings from the palm of the hand — just as they make these to a single Victor, so likewise to every single Victor without exception: such is the magical display of the seers' meditative absorption.

With the wisdom that gathers all beings, they perfect the supreme magical displays and meditative absorption. Through all manner of acts and service, through a thousand gates of skillful means, they tame sentient beings.

Some tame through the gate of making offerings to the Tathāgatas; some through the gate of giving inconceivable generosity; some through the gate of all aspects of moral discipline together with purified qualities; some through the gate of inexhaustible and unshakeable patience;

Some through the gate of diligence in ascetic discipline and austerities; some through the gate of resting in the perfect tranquility of meditative concentration; some through the gates of wisdom determining what is ultimately real; some through the gates of skillful means endowed with all practices;

Some through the divine abodes and the gates of higher knowledge; some through the gate of benefiting through the four means of gathering; some through the gates of accumulating merit and wisdom; some through the gates of truth, refuge, and liberation;

Some through the gate of the powers, faculties, and path; some through the gate of liberation by the śrāvaka vehicle; some through the gate of purification by the vehicle of conditions; some through the gate of magical display of the supreme vehicle;

Some through the gate of impermanence and suffering;

Some through the gates of selflessness and the absence of a living soul; some through the gate of the perception of ugliness and the gate of freedom from attachment; some through the gate of peace, cessation, and meditative absorption — taming beings in this way.

However many gates there are to the conduct of beings in this world, entering fully into that many gates of Dharma, through every gate of liberation, they tame the world's sentient beings according to their aspirations.

Those who, through every gate of liberation, intentionally tame the world's sentient beings — no one is able to seize upon them as an object of fixed observation. Such is the magical display of meditative absorption.

Their supreme meditative absorption of the arrangement of joy fully ripens and harmonizes all beings; endowed with happiness, bliss, delight, and supreme joy, their resolve made firm, they tame sentient beings.

In whatever world where a year is a time of famine and all the necessities of ease and comfort have become exceedingly rare, there they work with full intention, giving generously and carrying out the benefit of beings.

They give the finest food and drink, the finest flavors, garments and clothing of every precious variety; and bestowing kingdoms, wealth, and all that belongs to self, they tame beings who are inclined toward generosity.

Steadfast as they are, adorned with bodies bearing the supreme major marks, clothed and arrayed in the finest robes and ornaments, their hair braided and their bodies anointed with perfume — by displaying such forms, they tame sentient beings.

For those who are delighted and fully satisfied and supremely joyful at what they see, those ones of supreme intelligence display supreme and beautiful forms, revealing what is most excellent in form, thereby taming sentient beings who are inclined toward form.

With the sweet voice of the kalavinka bird, with the pleasing call that delights all like the cuckoo, with the sound of drums, of Brahmā, and of the kinnaras (half-human celestial musicians) — in accordance with every disposition, they teach the Dharma likewise.

Through the eighty-four thousand particular gates of the Dharma by which the Victors accomplish the welfare of beings, they tame the world's sentient beings according to their aspirations.

They become companions in pleasure and in suffering alike; they become companions in benefit and in harm as well; making themselves companions in every activity, through the gate of friendship they tame sentient beings.

The suffering, harm, and faults that are conditioned — these they endure for the sake of their companions; and for the happiness and welfare of all beings, they willingly accept the harm that comes with friendship.

In whatever place there is no emergence from home-life, no Dharma, no going to solitude, and liberation is not perceived as an object — there they fully abandon royal dominion and prosperity, and with a peaceful mind they go forth from home into homelessness.

They do so in order to fully liberate all beings from the bonds of home, from bondage, and from the conditions of conditioned existence; not dwelling in any of the joys of desire, they go forth and eloquently proclaim liberation.

They proclaim the ten practices of conduct, and the Dharmic conduct of great men in its entirety, and all the conduct of the seers without remainder; they declare this fully and accomplish the welfare of beings.

In whatever world beings live in immeasurable numbers with happiness and only minor afflictions, there they display themselves as afflicted by old age, threatened by illness, with children, subject to death and no longer their own masters — demonstrating the loss of self-control through death.

With attachment blazing, with aversion blazing fiercely, with the great fire of delusion blazing throughout the world, and with the fires of old age, sickness, and death blazing — by revealing such a world, they tame sentient beings.

They also proclaim through the ten powers of the buddhas, the four kinds of courageous fearlessness, and the eighteen special qualities of the Dharma, the nature of the greatness of buddhahood; and through the excellent qualities of the buddhas they accomplish the welfare of beings.

By demonstrating in all things magical displays through the blessings and power of form, following their all-encompassing proclamation, they display the miraculous power of the Tathāgatas; and through magical displays and their transformations, they tame sentient beings.

Through the many various kinds of skillful means, they travel throughout the world and accomplish the welfare of beings; unattached to the world like a lotus in water, they journey about inspiring joy and faith.

They become masters of poetry and royal song, masters of composition; they become skilled in dance, in drumming, in heroic arts, and in music. Holding beautiful ornaments and garlands, they perform dance; and as master illusionists they display forms of every kind throughout the world.

They become village headmen and town governors, helmsmen and pilots. In the same way they become caravan leaders, merchant chieftains, and householders. They become kings and ministers, heralds, messengers, physicians, and masters of worldly treatises and rituals.

In wilderness places they become great trees; they become medicines and inexhaustible treasuries of jewels, wish-fulfilling gems, and wish-granting trees. To those who have strayed from the path and fallen into ravines, they show the way.

Knowing that those who have newly entered the world are not yet acquainted with the modes of karma among sentient beings, they discourse to all of them on farming, trade, and various crafts and arts of the world.

Whatever endeavors are without harm or injury, which the wise praise as bringing happiness to sentient beings — all the various methods of mantras, medicines, and treatises — those sages proclaim them all.

Whatever the world of gods and men holds in reverence, whatever constitutes the supreme conduct of sages and the holy, and all the highest forms of vow-keeping, austerity, and ascetic practice — those skilled ones proclaim all of these.

Those who travel about attached to every kind of conduct, the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) and those who do not speak the teachings of Gautama, and those who follow the naked and unclad ascetics — to these also they appear as skilled masters and teachers.

Among those who maintain various rules of livelihood — those of higher standing and those of the highest, those who follow the vow of wearing long matted locks, and those who observe the vow of youth — among these too they become masters and teachers.

Among those who practice the five austerities facing the sun, those who follow the vows of dogs and cattle, those who roam as deer, those with crests, and the thirty-fold group of non-Buddhists — among these too they become their teachers.

Among those who delight in engaging with divine knowledge, and those who wander in the domain of the tīrthikas — even while subsisting on roots, fruits, and water — they are the supreme among those devoted to inconceivable teachings.

Among those who sit in a squatting posture, those who wander alone, those who lie on thorns and grass, those who lie in ashes, and those who dwell using wooden blocks as their bed — among these too they become their teachers.

Having come to understand the thoughts, aspirations, and understanding of all the tīrthikas of the outer schools, and through fierce and unbearable austerities that are hard to approach, they tame them by bringing about the abandonment of the suffering of the tīrthikas.

Knowing that the world is disturbed and confused by wrong views, to all the tīrthikas who abide in evil views, through subtle methods and skillful means, they reveal truth to each of them.

To some they reveal truth through the highly secret basis of flight-enabling mantras. To some they speak with clear and direct words; to others with the secret words of the gods. To some with words of analysis and letters; to others with vajra words that determine meaning; with words that tame opponents; with words of liberation from treatises and from those unable to be liberated by treatises.

To some with the words of non-human languages, and to all with the certain words of universal entry. To some with the certain words of gods, the certain words of nāgas, and the certain words of yakṣas. To others with the words of rākṣasas, elemental spirits, flesh-eaters, gandharvas, kinnaras, great nāgas, humans, asuras, and garuḍas — through these they reveal the truth and lead beings to liberation.

Knowing in this way the mode of truth and certain expression, they demonstrate — through understanding the inconceivable pathways of language of the entire nature of reality of the Victor's teachings without exception — the dharmatā in all its inconceivable reaches. Such is the meditative absorption of magical transformations.

This is the fourth and final fascicle.

The meditative absorption of supreme ease of travel among beings: accomplishing this fully for all beings, they spread out rays of light beyond all thought and imagination, and through spreading these rays of light, they tame

sentient beings.

They send forth rays of light that are beautiful to behold,
and whatever sentient beings come to know those rays of light —
their beholding them is not without purpose,
for it is the cause of the supreme, unsurpassable primordial wisdom.

To all people they fully reveal the buddhas,
fully reveal the Dharma, and show the path,
and by displaying the forms and stūpas of the Victors,
the rays of light that are beautiful to behold are thereby accomplished.

They send forth rays of light called "Light-maker" —
rays that overwhelm the radiance of the gods,
that dispel all dust and darkness,
and illuminate the world with that beneficent light.

Whatever sentient beings are stirred by that light
take up lamps in order to make offerings to the Victors.
Because they take up lamps to make offerings to the Victors,
they become Victors who are the light of the world.

Offering to the Victors lamps of grain-oil, butter-oil, and sesame-oil,
lamps of grass, wood, reeds, and lac,
and lamps of incense, medicinal essence, and precious substances —
by offering these, one attains the state of being a Light-maker.

They send forth rays of light called "Liberator,"
and whatever sentient beings are stirred by that light
don armor for the sake of liberating sentient beings
from the vast ocean of craving and conditioned existence.

Those who don armor for the sake of liberating sentient beings
from the vast ocean of craving and conditioned existence —
they fully liberate beings from the four rivers,
and show the city of happiness free from sorrow.

Building many bridges and walkways,
and drawing forth ferryboats to carry beings across rivers and roads,
by decrying conditioned existence and extolling the peace of nirvāṇa,
the rays of light of the Liberator are thereby accomplished.

They send forth rays of light that dispel thirst,
and whatever sentient beings are stirred by that light

utterly abandon the thirst for the qualities of desire,
and earnestly seek the taste of devotion to the Dharma.

Having utterly abandoned the thirst for the qualities of desire
and earnestly sought the taste of devotion to the Dharma,
they become buddhas who pour down a rain of ambrosia
and dispel the craving-thirst of the parched world.

By drawing ponds, rivers, springs, wells, and lakes
into the service of awakening,
and by disparaging desire and extolling meditative concentration,
the rays that dispel craving and thirst are thereby accomplished.

They send forth rays of light that bring joy,
and whatever sentient beings are stirred by that light
arouse the mind, thinking: "May joy increase and may I
become self-arisen for the sake of supreme awakening."

By fashioning images adorned with the marks of compassion's form,
seated upon lotus thrones,
and by constantly proclaiming the qualities of the buddhas,
the rays of light that bring joy are thereby accomplished.

They send forth rays of light that bring delight,
and whatever sentient beings are stirred by that light
constantly take joy and delight in the buddhas,
take joy and delight in the Dharma, and take joy and delight in the Saṅgha.

Those who constantly take joy and delight in the buddhas,
take joy and delight in the Dharma, and take joy and delight in the Saṅgha —
they come to dwell always in the company of the buddhas, the Dharma, and
the noble assembly,
and attain unsurpassable forbearance.

By stirring and reminding many sentient beings
to recollect the buddhas, the Dharma, and the supreme Saṅgha,
and by fully proclaiming the qualities of the awakening mind,
the rays of light that bring delight are thereby accomplished.

They send forth rays of light that accumulate merit,
and whatever sentient beings are stirred by that light
seek the aim of unsurpassable awakening

and make manifold and varied acts of generosity.

When performing those boundless acts of giving and offering,
they fulfill the wishes of all those who come seeking,
and by giving gifts that satisfy every aspiration,
the rays of light that accumulate merit are thereby accomplished.

They send forth rays of light endowed with primordial wisdom,
and whatever sentient beings are stirred by that light —
from a single gateway of Dharma they enter into many —

the gateways of Dharma are grasped in an instant,
and sentient beings are drawn into the distinctions of Dharma.
The primordial wisdom that is certain of meaning is fully opened,
and through the expression of the words and meaning of Dharma
those rays of light endowed with primordial wisdom are thereby accomplished.

They send forth rays of light that are a lamp of wisdom,
and whatever sentient beings are stirred by that light
enter into phenomena that are empty, selfless, unborn, and unarisen,
and that are devoid of intrinsic nature.

They are without a lord, empty of phenomena, without an agent —
like an illusion, a mirage, a moon reflected in water,
like a dream, like a reflection —
and by teaching this, the lamp of wisdom is accomplished.

They send forth rays of light that are magical displays of Dharma,
and whatever sentient beings are stirred by that light
attain the inexhaustible dhāraṇī of patient endurance
and also hold the treasury of all Tathāgatas.

By conferring full benefit on those who uphold the Dharma,
by protecting the sages (ṛṣis) through the Dharma,
and by guarding beings in their wandering through the Dharma,
the rays of light that are magical displays of Dharma are accomplished.

They send forth rays of light endowed with generosity,
and whatever sentient beings who are afflicted are stirred by that light
come to understand that enjoyments are impermanent and unstable,
and they turn ever joyful and devoted to giving.

Even untamed, hard-to-tame, miserly sentient beings,
upon recognizing that wealth is like a dream and like clouds,

practice generosity with a mind of joy,
and therefore the light endowed with giving is accomplished.

They send forth rays of light utterly free of burning anguish,
and whatever beings who transgress the precepts are stirred by that light
come to abide in pure moral discipline
and raise the aspiration: "May I become self-arisen."
Being fully purified in the paths of virtuous action
and established in moral discipline, they bring many sentient beings in as well,
and by also guiding them into a genuine hold on the awakening mind,
the rays of light utterly free of burning anguish are accomplished.

They send forth rays of light adorned with patience,
and whatever impatient sentient beings are stirred by that light
entirely abandon anger, resentment, and arrogance,
and turn ever devoted and joyful in patience.
By bearing with the wrongs of those who act wickedly,
and by not stirring up conflict for the sake of awakening,
and by praising and celebrating the virtues of patience at all times,
the rays of light adorned with patience are thereby accomplished.

They send forth rays of light endowed with exertion,
and whatever lazy sentient beings are stirred by that light
strive in what is fitting and come to make offerings to the Three Jewels
with an unflagging and tireless application.
By making offerings to the Three Jewels with tireless and unflagging
application,
those beings utterly transcend the path of the four māras
and swiftly come to touch unsurpassable awakening.
By drawing many sentient beings into diligence
and causing them to make thorough offerings to the Three Jewels,
and by fully upholding the sacred Dharma in the hour of its decline,
the rays of light endowed with exertion are thereby attained.

They send forth rays of light that bring peace,
and whatever disturbed sentient beings are stirred by that light
become free of attachment, free of aversion, free of bewilderment,
and upon realizing this, enter into a mind of meditative equipoise.
By completely abandoning association with companions in evil who are faulted

in conduct,
and by praising peaceful solitude and meditative concentration in remote places,
the rays of light that bring peace are thereby accomplished.

They send forth rays of light adorned with wisdom,
and however many sentient beings of confused intelligence are stirred by that light
come to fully comprehend and inwardly realize
the modes of truth, steadfastness, and liberation, and the understanding of the faculties.

By comprehending and inwardly realizing the modes of truth, steadfastness, and liberation, and the understanding of the faculties,
and by attaining the meditative absorption of the Sun-Lamp,
they become victors who cause the light of wisdom to shine.

Having fully relinquished royal dominion, wealth, and self,
and having sought out every Dharma for the sake of awakening —

Having honored that Dharma with reverence and proclaimed it excellently,
the ray of light arrayed with wisdom is thereby accomplished.

Sending forth the ray of light endowed with buddhas,
whatever sentient beings are stirred by that light
behold innumerable and inconceivable thousands of buddhas
seated upon exquisite lotuses.

Proclaiming the greatness of the buddhas, the liberation of the buddhas,
and the endless emanations of the buddhas,
and excellently proclaiming the powers and miraculous feats of the buddhas —
through this, the ray of light endowed with buddhas is accomplished.

Sending forth the ray of light that bestows fearlessness,
whatever sentient beings afflicted by fear are touched by it
become liberated from all fears of elemental spirits, planets, killing, beating, imprisonment,
and epidemic disease.

By protecting whatever sentient beings through the gift of fearlessness,
turning living creatures back from the act of killing,
and giving refuge to those who seek refuge from fear —
through this, that ray of light bestowing fearlessness is accomplished.

Sending forth the ray of light that creates all happiness,
whatever sick and ailing beings are touched by it
become liberated in every way from the suffering of illness
and also attain the happiness of meditative concentration and meditative
absorption.

This is attained by giving the fruits of healing — medicines and roots,
precious elixirs, incense and unguents,
sugar, honey, milk and pure butter,
grain oil, food and drink.

Sending forth the ray of light that reveals the buddhas,
whatever beings are stirred by it at the very end, when their life is exhausted,
will recollect the buddhas and come to behold the buddhas.

At death they will pass on and go to buddha-fields.

At the hour of death, recollecting the buddhas,
delighting them by manifesting the form-bodies of the Victors,
and at the moment of death proclaiming the buddhas as refuge —
through this, that ray of light that reveals the buddhas is attained.

Sending forth the ray of light that excellently proclaims the Dharma,
whatever sentient beings are stirred by that light
listen to the Dharma, recite it, and commit it to writing,
and they come always to delight in and be devoted to the Dharma.
When a famine of the Dharma arises, proclaiming the Dharma,
fulfilling the aspirations of those who seek the Dharma,
and declaring, "Arouse your intention and be diligent in the Dharma!" —
through this proclamation, the excellent proclaiming of the Dharma is
attained.

Sending forth the ray of light endowed with melody
for the purpose of thoroughly rousing the sons of the buddhas,
however many streams of sound there are in the three worlds
are all heard as the speech of the Tathāgatas.

Praising the great seers with the sound of secret praise,
for the sake of the Victor's voice, giving resonant small cymbals
and great-sounding bells to all beings,
and proclaiming this throughout — through this, the ray endowed with melody
is accomplished.

Sending forth the ray of light that bestows immortality,
whatever sentient beings are stirred by that light
utterly abandon all careless and heedless conduct
and take up the practice of striving in all virtuous qualities.
Proclaiming that conditioned things are never truly happy,
pervaded throughout by many harms and sufferings,
and that cessation is always blissful, peaceful, and at ease —
through this, the bestowal of immortality is attained.

Sending forth the ray of light endowed with distinction,
whatever sentient beings are stirred by that light
hear of the distinctive moral discipline of the Victors,
the distinctive meditative absorption, the distinctive wisdom.
Praising and extolling for the sake of awakening:
"Through the supreme moral discipline of the great Sage-King,
one becomes supreme in meditative absorption and supreme in wisdom" —
through this, the ray endowed with distinction is accomplished.

Sending forth the ray of light arrayed with jewels,
whatever sentient beings are stirred by that light
come to obtain inexhaustible treasure-troves of jewels
and make offerings to the great seers with precious gems.
Offering jewels to kings and to the jeweled stūpas of the Victors,
gathering beings afflicted by mental afflictions through jewels,
and excellently offering jewels to the Victors —
through this, the ray of light arrayed with jewels is accomplished.

Sending forth the ray of light that brilliantly illuminates incense,
whatever sentient beings are stirred by that light
experience the pleasing perception of incense unparalleled among humans,
they will come to certainty in the qualities of the buddhas. Through incense
and unguents of humans and gods, making excellent offering to the foremost
among men, and through fashioning images of the Victors and stūpas from
incense — by this, the ray of light brilliantly illuminating incense is
accomplished.

Sending forth the ray of light arranged in manifold array,
adorned with victory banners, pennants, and the finest parasols in great
variety,
with music resounding and incense wafting,

beautifying the sacred palace with flowers strewn —
welcoming the Victors with music,
and making offerings of flowers, unguents, incense, and powdered perfume,
together with victory banners, pennants, and the finest parasols —
through this, the ray of light of manifold array is accomplished.

Sending forth the ray of light that brings utter clarity,
it causes all lands to abide as smooth as the palm of a hand.
Through purifying stūpas and the dwelling places of sages —
by this, the ray of utterly clear light is accomplished.

Sending forth the ray of light endowed with clouds,
everywhere there arise clouds that rain down incense.
Through consecrating the ground around stūpas with perfumed water —
by this, the ray of light endowed with clouds is fully attained.

Sending forth the ray of light arranged in billowing splendor,
those who are naked come to have clothing, and those who have clothing
come to have adornments.

Through giving clothing, robes, and garlands of ornaments in great variety —
by this, the ray of light of billowing splendor is accomplished.

Sending forth the ray of light endowed with supreme flavor,
those who are hungry come to obtain food of supreme taste.
Through giving food, drink, and every variety of supreme flavor —
by this, the ray of light endowed with supreme flavor is accomplished.

Sending forth the ray of light that reveals riches,
the poor come to obtain treasure-troves of precious gems.
Through offering inexhaustible foundations of treasure to the Three Jewels —
by this, the ray of light that reveals riches is attained.

Sending forth the ray of light that purifies eyes,
at that time the blind come to see forms of every variety.
Through offering lamps to the Victors and to the stūpas of the Victors —
by this, the ray of light that purifies eyes is accomplished.

Sending forth the ray of light that purifies ears,
those whose hearing is impaired come to hear many sounds.
Through offering music to the Victors and to the stūpas of the Victors —
by this, the ray of light that purifies ears is accomplished.

Sending forth the ray of light that purifies the nose,
those who had not perceived fragrance before come to smell exquisite scents.
Through offering finest incense to the Victors and to the stūpas of the Victors
—

by this, the ray of light that purifies the nose is accomplished.

Sending forth the ray of light that purifies the tongue,
with pleasant and delightful words one praises the buddhas,
abandoning all speech that is harsh and foul.
Through speaking gently — by this, the ray of light that purifies the tongue is
accomplished.

Sending forth the ray of light that purifies the body,
those whose faculties are impaired come to be endowed with full faculties.
Through prostrating the body to the Victors and to the stūpas of the Victors —
by this, the attainment of the purification of the body is accomplished.

Sending forth the ray of light that purifies mind,
all those who are deranged come to be endowed with mind.
Through leading beings' minds in the wake of mastery in meditative
absorption —
by this, the ray of light that purifies mind is accomplished.

Sending forth the ray of light that purifies form,
the lords among men behold inconceivable bodies.
Through adorning stūpas with images of bodies and paintings in great variety
—
by this, the ray of light that purifies form is accomplished.

Sending forth the ray of light that purifies sound,
one comes to know fully that sound is not empty of sound —
that arising from conditions, it is like an echo.
Through teaching this about sounds — by this, that ray of light is
accomplished.

Sending forth the ray of light that purifies scent,
all smells become the most exquisite fragrance.
Through bathing the stūpas of the Victors with water mixed with finest incense
—
that is the light of the awakening field.

Sending forth the ray of light that purifies taste,
even poisonous things become the supreme of tastes, free from harm.
Through offering all manner of supreme flavors to the buddhas together with
their śrāvakas, and to one's parents —
that is that ray of light.

Sending forth the ray of light that purifies touch,
whatever is rough upon contact becomes soft and pleasant.
Showers of short spears, three-pronged weapons, great swords, and arrows —
Garlands transform into lotuses and blue water-lilies,
and the many fine, soft, pleasant-to-touch bolts of silk cloth —
spread out in the wake of the Victors as they pass,
with flowers, ointments, soft garments and garlands piled high in offering:
that is that ray of light.

Sending forth the ray of light that purifies phenomena,
all the inconceivable phenomena streaming forth from every pore
of all the Victors — who work the welfare of the world —
upon being heard, satisfy every aspiration.

"What arises from conditions is unborn in essential nature;
the bodies of the Victors are the dharmakāya,
and the nature of reality abides forever, like the sky" —
by declaring this, one attains the purification of phenomena.

As for those rays of light — the ray of the gate and the rest —
from a single pore-gate of the sages there issue forth
rays of light as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges,
each with its own distinct function and mode of action.

Just as from that single pore-gate
rays of light as numerous as the Ganges' sands arise,
so too from every single pore without exception:
such is the miraculous display of the samādhi of the sages.

The qualities through which those rays of light are accomplished —
the beings who previously served as their companions —
from those very companions the rays stream forth abundantly:
such is the miraculous display of the gnosis of the sages.
Those who formerly were companions in merit to these beings,
who expressed rejoicing and offered prayers,
who beheld them and accumulated virtue —

all of those come to know those rays of light.

Those who have performed merit and accumulated virtue,
those who again and again have made offerings to the buddhas
and who earnestly seek and desire the qualities of buddhahood —
to all of these the rays of light give their urging.

Consider the analogy of a blind person: though they cannot see the sun,
the sun is not absent; it rises upon the purified world.

But it is one endowed with eyes who knows that it has risen,
and all then go about their own respective activities.

In the same way, all those rays of light of the great beings
stream forth abundantly, yet are imperiled by wrong views,
and those of diminished faith, the ordinary ones, do not see them —
yet for those of wide intelligence they are present.

Consider too the analogy of an adorned jewel, a horse, a palace,
nourishing essences, and precious ointments and perfumes:

these exist for the great and powerful,
yet for those who have fallen into poverty they are absent.

In the same way, those rays of light of the great beings —
though present, they are imperiled by wrong views,
and those whose faith has diminished do not see them —
yet for those of wide intelligence they are present.

Those who, having heard this exposition of the rays of light,
give rise to faith, devotion, and serene clarity —
they do not produce doubt and suspicion, thinking,
"Shall I become possessed of great qualities, or shall I not?"

Those arrays of attendants and retinues displaying miraculous form
accomplish the perfection of supreme samādhi,
and throughout all ten directions they reveal to the unrivaled ones'
long-standing children of the buddhas the Teacher himself.

Those arrays of light — varied lotuses —
having blessed a region the measure of a thousand-millionfold world system,
display a body seated in cross-legged posture pervading all:
such is the miraculous display of samādhi.

Yet other lotuses, as numerous as the dust-motes of ten buddha-fields,
together with their retinues, are blessed,

and the children of the buddhas, surrounded by all their assemblies,
abide within those samādhis as samādhis themselves.

Those sentient beings whom that sage has fully ripened
and who have well accomplished buddhahood —
these surround that great lotus,
and all stand gazing with palms pressed together.

This is the very nature of reality of great beings
who have thoroughly entered into the abiding of samādhi:
they are each encircled entirely by their own disciples,
just as the moon is encircled by a host of stars.

How these fully enter into a single direction
and reveal to the servant-like children of the buddhas —
and reveal to all directions without exception —
such is this wondrous display of samādhi.

Those who dwell pervading the net of directions
accomplish the supreme samādhi,
and some while in equipoise, some while risen,
reveal their bodies in all ten directions.

Some enter equipoise in the eastern direction
while the heroic ones rise from the western direction;
some enter equipoise in the western direction
while the great beings rise from the eastern direction.
In just this way they fully enter into all ten directions:
while entering equipoise in one direction,
those rich in the qualities of primordial wisdom rise from another.
Such is the wondrous display of the sage's samādhi.

In all the countless buddha-fields of the eastern direction,
those self-arisen ones without exception —
before the presence of their own feet and before those lords,
they appear as abiding in the peaceful meditative absorption.

Having been shown that they enter equipoise in that direction,
the heroic ones rise throughout all the western fields without exception,
and appear to make many and varied offerings
directly before all the Victors.

In all the countless buddha-fields of the western direction,
the buddhas who abide without exception —
before the presence of their own feet and before those lords,
they appear as abiding in the peaceful meditative absorption.

Having been shown that they enter equipoise in that direction,
the heroic ones rise throughout all the eastern fields without exception,
and appear to make many and varied offerings
directly before all the Victors.

In just this way, throughout the fields of all ten directions,
stability enters everywhere throughout all directions without exception.
Some are in equipoise and some have risen,
and they appear to make offerings to the lamps of the world.

Those who enter equipoise through the gateway of the eye
rise as great beings through the gateway of form.
When they display forms inconceivable in number,
the world together with its gods becomes bewildered at this.

Entering equipoise through the gateway of form,
the eye is of a nature that is unborn and unarisen;
they display it clearly as empty and without agent,
and rise mindfully through the gateway of the eye.

Those who enter equipoise through the gateway of the ear
rise as great beings through the gateway of sound.
Wherever the world together with its gods becomes bewildered,
they fully enter into all sounds and voices.

Entering equipoise through the gateway of sound,
the ear is of a nature that is unborn and unarisen;
they display it clearly as empty and without agent,
and rise mindfully through the gateway of the ear.

Those who enter equipoise through the gateway of the nose
rise as great beings through the gateway of scent.
Wherever the world together with its gods becomes bewildered,
they fully enter into the offering of the supreme and noble fragrance.

Entering equipoise through the gateway of scent,
the nose is of a nature that is unborn and unarisen;
they display it clearly as empty and without agent,

and rise mindfully through the gateway of the nose.

Those who enter equipoise through the gateway of the tongue
rise through the gateway of all supreme tastes.

Wherever the world together with its gods becomes bewildered,
the great beings are endowed with those supreme tastes.

Entering equipoise through the gateway of all supreme tastes,
the tongue is of a nature that is unborn and unarisen;
they display it clearly as empty and without agent,
and rise mindfully through the gateway of the tongue.

Those who enter equipoise through the gateway of the body
rise as great beings through the gateway of touch.
Wherever the world together with its gods becomes bewildered,
they fully enter into the touch that gives rise to the world's joy.

Entering equipoise through the gateway of touch,
the body is of a nature that is unborn and unarisen;
they display it clearly as empty and without agent,
and rise mindfully through the gateway of the body.

Those who enter equipoise through the gateway of the mind
rise as great beings through the gateway of phenomena.
Wherever the world together with its gods becomes bewildered,
they fully enter into the engagement that abides in phenomena.

Entering equipoise through the pathways of phenomena,
the mind is of a nature that is unborn and unarisen;
they display it clearly as empty and without agent,
and rise mindfully through the gateway of the mind.

They enter equipoise in the body of a child,
and rise from those who abide in the vigor of youth.

They enter equipoise in those who abide in the vigor of youth,
and rise from the body of the aged and infirm.

They enter equipoise in the body of the aged and infirm,
and rise from the body of a faithful laywoman.

They enter equipoise in the body of a faithful laywoman,
and rise from the body of a faithful layman.

They enter equipoise in the body of a faithful layman,

and rise from the body of a nun.

They enter equipoise in the body of a nun,
and rise from the body of a monk of great learning.

They enter equipoise in the body of a monk of great learning,
and rise from the body of one in training and one beyond training.

They enter equipoise in the body of one in training and one beyond training,
and rise from the body of a pratyekabuddha.

They enter equipoise in the body of a pratyekabuddha,
and rise from the supreme body of a buddha.

They enter equipoise in the supreme body of a buddha,
and rise from the form and body of a god.

They enter equipoise in the form and body of a god,
and rise from the body of a great-miracle-working nāga.

They enter equipoise in the body of a great-miracle-working nāga,
and rise from the body of a great-miracle-working yakṣa.

They enter equipoise in the body of a great-miracle-working yakṣa,
and rise from the body of every class of elemental spirit.

They enter equipoise in the body of every class of elemental spirit,
and rise from a single pore.

They enter equipoise in a single pore,
and rise from every pore.

They enter equipoise in every pore,
and rise from the breadth of a single hair-tip.

They enter equipoise in the breadth of a single hair-tip,
and rise from the breadth of every hair-tip.

They enter equipoise in the breadth of every hair-tip,
and rise from the finest of fine particles.

They enter equipoise in a single particle,
and rise from every single particle without exception.

They enter equipoise in every particle without exception,
and rise from the vajra-foundation of the ocean.

They enter equipoise in the vajra-foundation of the ocean,
and rise from the jewel-trees' fruits.

Having entered equipoise in those fruits,
they rise through the gateway of the rays of light of the Victors.

They enter equipoise in the gateway of the Victors' rays of light,
and rise from the rivers and streams of the ocean's waters.

They enter equipoise in the rivers and streams of the ocean's waters,
and rise, as great beings, through the pathway of fire.

They enter equipoise in the pathway of fire,
and rise mindfully through the pathway of wind.

They enter equipoise in the pathway of wind,
and rise, as great beings, from the ground of earth.

They enter equipoise in the ground of earth,
and rise from all the divine palaces of the gods.

They enter equipoise in all the divine palaces of the gods,
and those mindful ones rise from space.

The samādhis and liberations of those beings who have gathered qualities beyond measure are inconceivable. Even if all the Victors were to expound upon them for immeasurable eons, they could not exhaust them. The karmic maturation of those beings transcends thought, and even what all the Victors have declared of them — the inconceivable emanations of nāgas, the inconceivable emanations of buddhas, and the inconceivable emanations that are objects of thought and meditative concentration — all of these are still to be illustrated by examples. Yet no parallel analogy for them exists. If examples are set forth by learned and intelligent persons, the meanings will be understood swiftly.

A śrāvaka who has mastered the eight liberations becomes one, then becomes many; having become many, becomes one again; in the sky they resolve upon meditative concentration and blaze with fire. Below, flames of fire blaze; above, streams of water flow.

Above, flames of fire blaze; below, streams of water flow. Walking, standing, lying down, sitting — the body's miraculous transformations in a single instant are inconceivable.

Yet this being lacks great compassion, does not seek awakening, and has turned away from the world. If even such a one can display inconceivable emanations of the body, why would those who wish to benefit the world not display them?

The sun and moon wish to travel through the sky, and they display their reflections in all the bodies of water in every direction — in oceans, lakes, ponds, pools, channels, jewels, great seas, and rivers. Likewise, the inconceivable forms of that hero, that courageous being, are displayed in all

ten directions. He is skilled in all modes of meditative absorption and liberation.

For him — the Tathāgata, the self-arisen lord — the army with its four divisions is arrayed on the lake of his clarity, and each soldier sees his own reflection. They see swords, great arrows, bows and arrows, armor worn, mounts ridden, and vehicles — whatever form, whatever place, whatever appearance, whatever accoutrements belong to each, all of these are seen just so in the water. Yet the water holds no love, no hatred, no conceptual thought. Such is the miraculous transformation of the sage's meditative absorption.

There is a goddess of the ocean called Resounding. Among all the beings born in the ocean, she is skilled in every kind of sound and melody, and with her own voice she satisfies all voices. This Resounding one, though possessed of attachment, aversion, and delusion, is skilled in the sounds and modes of every voice. If then those who have mastered the power of dhāraṇī and Dharma can satisfy the world including the gods, why would they not do so?

The wife of the Tumburu gandharva, a melodious woman, is a daughter of Brahmā (Brahmā), born of mind alone. She enters through the doorway of the mind, the mentation, and the mouth of those who delight in truth, in vows, in non-harm. Though this melodious one is herself possessed of attachment and aversion, she delights the world with charming sounds fashioned through the harmonious register of melodic phrases suited to disciplined conduct. How much more, then, should those rich in wisdom and excellent qualities not do likewise?

A master illusionist skilled in spells and incantations displays boundless forms of every variety — displaying fine and magnificent houses of great beauty for days and nights, for moments, for months, and for a hundred years. If even a master illusionist possessed of attachment and aversion can delight the world with illusory emanations, why would those well trained in meditative concentration, higher knowledge, and liberation, and skilled in conduct, not delight it?

When the gods and asuras (demigods) contend in battle, and the victorious gods defeat the asuras, the asuras, overcome by fear, flee with their parasols, their armor, their vehicles, their armies, and their garments. Though these powerful lords of the gods are possessed of attachment and aversion, they display inconceivable emanations of the body. Why then would those heroes who abide in sovereign miraculous power not display the body's emanations?

The elephant Airāvaṇa (Airāvaṇa), who bears the vajra and is the son of the earth-guardian, is the great miraculous mount belonging to the retinue of Indra (Śakra, the lord of gods). He manifests thirty-three heads, and on each of those heads six tusks. On each of those tusks he emanates seven ponds filled with water. In each pond he emanates seven lotus flowers of varied kinds arranged in array. On each lotus he emanates seven divine maidens who know every art. These maidens are skilled in games, song, and dance, and they play together with Indra, the lord of the thirty-three. This elephant also transforms his body and mingles and blends with all the gods, his conduct and every enjoyment matching theirs. Such is the appearance of the supreme elephant's miraculous emanation.

Though that elephant is possessed of attachment, aversion, and delusion, it displays such miraculous power. How then would those trained in the power of wisdom and skillful means not produce a hundred emanations through meditative absorption?

Rāhu (Rāhu, the eclipse-demon) transforms his body at will, sets his feet on the vajra foundation, and is displayed as reaching only to the navel of the ocean.

His head reaches level with the very peak of Mount Meru. Though Rāhu possesses attachment, aversion, and delusion, he displays such miraculous power as this. How then would the Light of the World, the supreme vanquisher of māras, not display limitless miraculous power?

Śakra (Indra, king of the gods) manifests innumerable emanations. When the gods and the lord of the asuras do battle, however many tens of millions of asuras are scattered in defeat, that same number does Śakra emanate from his own body. Every lord of the asuras and all the common asuras alike know that Śakra stands before each and every one of them. Then comes the cry: "He has been seized by the vajra-bearer!" All the lords of the asuras are thrown into confusion and dread. Displaying a thousand terrifying eyes, grasping a blazing vajra of fire, his body arrayed in armor of overwhelming and unapproachable majesty — beholding that Śakra, the lord of the asuras flees. And yet it is merely through the power and might of his ordinary merit that he produces such emanations for the sake of the king of the gods. How then would those who have become the refuge of all beings without exception, who possess inexhaustible merit, not produce emanations?

The drum that stirs the gods is itself accomplished through the ripening of divine karma. Knowing that the gods dwell in heedlessness, that drum sounds forth from the sky:

All desires are impermanent, without core,
unstable, inconstant — their very nature is lowliness.
They are like illusions, mirages, and the moon reflected in water;
all existence is like a dream, like clouds.
All heedlessness is fraught with enmity and sorrow;
it is the path of death, not the path of deathlessness.
All those, whoever they may be, who abide in heedlessness
are seized by the great sea-monster of the lord of death.
All of it is the root that grasps at suffering.
All birth is condemned by the noble ones.
You are deluded about the objects of sensual pleasures —
ever delight, therefore, in the power of the Dharma.

Thus urged on by that drum, Śakra and the gods assemble in their divine assembly hall where they sit well in the Dharma, and the speech of peace, free from attachment and consonant with it, that speech of Dharma, is proclaimed to all the gods.

Though that drum has no form to be shown, it accomplishes great purpose in just this way through the sound of the drum. How then would those who display forms according to their intention not accomplish great purpose for all beings?

When the gods and the lord of the asuras do battle, through the surpassing power and might of the gods' merit, the sound of the drum that stirs the gods rings out, proclaiming: "Gods, have no fear!" Urged on by the drum, the gods are filled with joy; their fear departs and their strength is born anew. The lords of the asuras, stricken with fear and overwhelmed by terror, flee in that very moment together with their armies.

So too, those who are like a drum that gives forth its sound — those who are the refuge and allied force for all beings, who have vanquished the māras of affliction and are possessed of great compassion — proclaim the sound of peace and dispel afflictions.

The ninety-two divine maidens of Śakra are all made joyful by Śakra's emanations. Each one believes that she alone is sporting with Śakra; and just as it is for one, so it is for all the goddesses alike. Even while he appears to be

dwelling intimately with all the goddesses, he is present in just the same way in the assembly hall of excellent Dharma. He appears to be teaching the Dharma excellently to all the gods, and in a single instant Śakra produces all these emanations.

Even Śakra, possessed as he is of attachment, aversion, and delusion, gladdens his own retinue through emanation. Why then would those who are tirelessly devoted to the welfare of beings not gladden the world through the power of miraculous display?

The disturber (māra) rules over beings and holds them in his power; these very sentient beings all desire to be under his sway. Because all ordinary persons enter entirely into karma and affliction, they are all bound by that māra.

Even that māra, possessed of attachment, aversion, and delusion, brings all beings under his power.

What then need be said of those who have attained the ten masteries and gained dominion? They do not place all beings on their own side alone.

Brahmā, lord over the triple-thousand world-system, appears simultaneously in all the brahma-realms of that triple-thousand world, however many there may be, and resounds in an exceedingly pleasing Brahmā-voice. Yet that Brahmā performs his miracles through the meditative concentrations and superknowledges of a worldly brahma-path. How then would those who dwell in the unsurpassed meditative absorptions and liberations that utterly transcend the world not perform miracles?

Consider the miraculous display of the consciousness of the Great Lord (Śiva). Vast ocean-clouds scatter their drops of rain, equaling all things in a single instant; yet even the count of a few drops is unknown, as though they were not there. Those who have trained through inconceivably many aeons of training and have attained the unsurpassed gnosis of awakening — why would they, in a single instant of mind, not know the minds of every being without exception?

Because the karmic maturation of sentient beings is inconceivable, this entire world arose from wind. Oceans, mountains, and the celestial palaces of the gods, and the varied spread of precious gems and scattered seeds — all came forth. From wind, clouds arise and rain falls everywhere; wind also thoroughly calms the clouds. Wind causes the crops of the world to grow and produces benefit for all beings. That wind has trained in none of the perfections and has

trained in none of the qualities of a buddha, and yet it displays inconceivable maturations for the world. Why then would those who have attained the supreme not display such things?

The thunder-voiced mass of clouds over the ocean resounds with pleasing sounds for all sentient beings — the calls of birds, the cries of wild animals, the voices of men, women, girls, and boys, and whatever other sounds there are. Knowing in that way that pleasing sound has no intrinsic nature, one comes to be endowed with uninhibited confidence, and having spoken pleasing sound to all beings, one gladdens the world with a beautiful voice.

This ocean has the quality of wonder and marvel. It is called an ocean because all beings are comparable to the ocean in breadth. Its water, elemental spirits, and jewels come without exhaustion; those who grasp at its waters cannot become sated. In the same way, those ones are like an ocean for all beings: their merit, meditative absorptions, liberations, wisdom, gnosis, and all qualities are inexhaustible; one cannot become sated with the accumulation of merit, qualities, and the like.

When the nāgas of the ocean play, they fill great clouds from the very foundation of the earth up to the realm of sovereignty, along with the four continents, and all of these display many and varied arrangements.

In the realm of sovereignty over Jambudvīpa, clouds of golden hue appear. In the realm of Nirmāṇarati they are like the color of red pearls. In the realm of Tuṣita they are like the color of snow-white cranes. In the realm of Yāma they are deep blue lapis lazuli. In the realm of the Thirty-Three they are like the essence of stone. In the realm of the guardians they are like the color of crystal. Over the ocean they are like the hardness of an unbreakable vajra. In the realm of human beings they are like heaps of the finest incense. In the realm of the nāgas they are like the color of lotuses. In the secret realm they are like the dance of swans. In the realm of the asuras they are like the color of cliffs and crags. To the north they show a hue like rays of golden light. And in the other continents they display still other varied arrangements.

In Jambudvīpa they are like blue mountains, and wherever the clouds are high, so they appear accordingly. Having displayed golden clouds in the realm of sovereignty, they also flash with lightning of a color like the sun. In the realm of Nirmāṇarati they are like beautiful moonlight. In the realm of Tuṣita they are like the gold of Jambudvīpa. In the realm of Yāma they are like the color of snow-white cranes. In the realm of the Thirty-Three they are like rays of gold.

In the realm of the guardians they are like the color of the essence of Śrī. Over the ocean they display a color like red pearls. In the realm of human beings they are deep blue lapis lazuli. In the realm of the nāgas they are like the color of the essence of Śrī. In the secret realm they are like the color of crystal. In the realm of the asuras they are like the essence of stone. To the north they display a hue like the color of jewel-stars. And in the other continents the arrangements are each different and distinct.

In Jambudvīpa the moon-jewel blazes bright,
And lightning fitting the nature of clouds is released.
There it resounds with the sound of Brahmā in the realm of Māra's sovereign;
In the realm of Nirmāṇarati it causes the sound of drums to roll.
In Tuṣita there is the sound of lovely, melodious music.
In the realm free from strife there is the sound of divine maidens.
In the Realm of the Thirty-Three there is the sound of countless human voices.
In the realm of the guardians it is the sound of gandharvas.
Over the great ocean it resembles the sound of waves crashing against rocks.
In the realm of the Mici it is the sound of the flute called kuṇāla.
In the realm of the nāgas it is the sound of the kalaviṅka bird.
In the secret realm it is the sound of nāga maidens.
In the realm of the asuras it is the sound of the divine kettledrum.
In the realm of humans it is the sound of the ocean flute.

There in the realm of Māra's sovereign the fragrance of divine incense arises,
And a rain of varied flowers arranged in display descends.
In Nirmāṇarati there falls a rain of flowers like moonlight resembling the fair moon,
Garlands of mādāra flowers and anointing unguents.
In Tuṣita there descends the color of great jewels,
Excellent ornaments, various precious things,
Crest-jewels like the moon,
And a rain of golden-hued silk garments.
Victory banners, parasols, and varied pennants,
Garlands and ornaments and anointing substances,
Red pearls, gold, and silk,
And sweet-sounding, lovely cymbals rain down in the realm free from strife.
In the Realm of the Thirty-Three, a supreme wish-fulfilling jewel.
In the realm of the guardians, the finest heartwood of sandalwood,
Saffron, elāvaluka, the divine tree tagara and tamāla,

Streams of perfumed water and abundant flowers rain down.
In the realm of the guardians, the lord of nāgas
Causes to rain down foods and drinks
That bring growth to the feeble and faint,
Endowed with good color, fragrance, and taste,
And beyond these, inconceivable jewels in a shower.
And there continually over the great ocean
Streams of rain fall without cease, equal to the size of axle-trees,
Great glorious inexhaustible treasuries,
And a rain of jewel-arrangements without limit descends.
In the realm of the Mici there descend various ornament-garlands,
Lotuses, blue lotuses, cloth, and precious things,
Flowers, varṣa, mālikā, and powdered incense,
The sweet sounds of lutes, flutes, melodious kettledrums.
In the realm of the nāgas, red pearls;
In the secret realm, jewels resembling the color of jewel-stars.
In the realm of the asuras, swords, great arrows,
Enemy-subduing bows, and a rain of quivers descends.
To the north it rains royal garlands of jewels,
Garlands of varṣa, mālikā, and campā flowers,
Kurantaka, atimuktaka rain down.
And in the other continents a rain of varied things descends.
In Jambudvīpa a continuous and fine rain
Of clear and pure water descends according to its nature,
Giving rise in the worlds to flowers, fruits, medicines, incense, trees,
And crops that bring ease and happiness.
Thus the arrangements of clouds are inconceivable,
And though they send down lightning, roll thunder, and pour arranged rains,
They do not stir from their place and have no conceptual thought.
Such are the inconceivable manifestations of the nāgas.
And likewise those who dwell in the waters of the ocean,
While their nāga manifestations display what is beyond reckoning —
Those who have entered the ocean of Dharma are rich in qualities;
Why then would they not display manifestations beyond reckoning?

By these examples, which are but a fraction of what could be said,
The great beings among them have been described.
Those heroes transcend all analogies;
They exercise sovereign command over liberation of such a kind.

Those endowed with supreme intelligence, with vast intelligence,
With unerring intelligence, with limitless intelligence,
With supreme wisdom, possessed of exceptional understanding —
Their supreme liberations have been set forth as these.

Whoever hears these sublime liberations,
Holds them with faith, and proclaims them throughout the world —
These are beings possessed of wondrous and extraordinary qualities,
Bringing joy in the world of human beings.
In this kind of Dharma, those who place their faith
Are rare among the assemblies of ordinary, individual sentient beings.

Those who have accumulated virtue and created merit —
Through the power of that cause, they place their faith in this.
Those who place their faith even in the vehicle of the śrāvakas
Are rare among human beings in the world of humans.
Rarer still are those for whom the vehicle of conditions,
The vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas, arises.
Those who enter the Great Vehicle are rarer than that.
If even placing faith in this Dharma is exceedingly rare,
What need is there to speak of those who engage in and uphold it?
What need then to speak of those who actually practice it accordingly?

Those who would lift up the great trichiliocosm together with its mountains
and oceans upon their heads for an entire eon — the deed they would
accomplish by placing faith in this Dharma is not of that order.

As for those who would serve and honor, with every happiness, all the sentient
beings as numerous as the atoms of the great trichiliocosm for an entire eon
— the merit that comes from placing faith in this Dharma surpasses that; no
such exceptional merit is to be found there.

Those who would carry ten world-systems together with their mountains and
oceans in the palms of their hands for an entire eon — the deed accomplished
by placing faith in this Dharma is not of that order.

As for those who would serve and honor, with every virtue, all the sentient beings as numerous as the atoms of ten world-systems for an entire eon — the merit that comes from placing faith in this Dharma surpasses that; no such exceptional merit is to be found there.

As for those who would serve and honor, with every happiness, all the buddhas as numerous as the atoms of ten world-systems for an entire eon — whoever has upheld this chapter of Dharma, their merit surpasses even that and is altogether superior.

When these liberations were thus supremely proclaimed,
All the world-systems in the ten directions shook,
The abodes of the māras were thrown into disarray,
And by the arising of that sound the lower realms were utterly pacified.
The lion-like human beings of all ten directions
Each appeared and showed their faces,
And extending their right hands, they placed upon the head of Śrī Bhadra
Their hands filled with boundless qualities.
Touching their palms to his head, they declared:
"It is well that these liberations have been so excellently taught.
You have taught well — we rejoice in this!"
Thus did all those buddhas speak.

Then, having spoken these verses, the Blessed One fell silent.

Thereupon all the gods, humans, and non-humans present in this great trichiliocosm world-system exclaimed: "The Tathāgata has declared this most excellently. How wondrous! The Tathāgata has turned the wheel of Dharma a second time. This teaching we have never heard before. Those sentient beings who will come to encounter this enumeration of Dharma are exceedingly rare. Such sentient beings do not possess paltry or inferior roots of virtue. Such sentient beings will have served and honored many buddhas. Such sentient beings will become like stūpas for the world together with its gods, māras, and Brahmā. Neither māras, nor the gods of the māra-class, nor those who have gone forth, nor those who dwell in households, nor likewise kings, nor great ministers, nor householders will be able to harm them." And they raised a great cry of rejoicing.

Then the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, it is rare for such jewel-like sūtras as this to appear in the world. And yet, through the power of the Tathāgata, a Dharma such as this has arisen

in the world, and through that very power of the Tathāgata those sentient beings, too, have come to hear it."

Then the Blessed One extended his tongue-faculty and spoke to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, take up this enumeration of Dharma."

"Receive it, hold it, master it fully." Then the venerable Ānanda circumambulated the Blessed One three times and said these words: "Blessed One, I shall take up this enumeration of Dharma and henceforth never allow it to be lost." After the Blessed One had spoken these words, the entire assembly of bodhisattvas endowed with all qualities, together with the noble bodhisattva Samantabhadra, with Mañjuśrī the Ever-Youthful, with the venerable Śāriputra, with other great hearers, and with gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas — all the world rejoiced and gave fervent praise to what the Blessed One had proclaimed.

This concludes the enumeration of Dharma known as the Noble Dhāraṇī of the Precious Tāla Tree.

Translator's Notes

- The title dhāraṇī "Jewel Meteor" renders ratnolkā, where olkā means a meteor or falling fire-brand; this is a standard rendering in the canon and should be understood as a luminous, blazing jewel-like meteor rather than a comet.

The phrase rendered "solely skilled" translates *śa stag*, an emphatic particle meaning "exclusively" or "nothing but," emphasizing that these monks were purely and completely dedicated to seeking primordial wisdom.

The bodhisattva name "Precious Mudrā in Hand" (lag na phyag rgya rin po che) is distinct from Vajrapāṇi (lag na rdo rje), who appears separately later in the list; both are present in this assembly.

- The term rendered "Jewel Tālā" transliterates the Tibetan phonetic rendering of a dhāraṇī name. The Sanskrit is uncertain; "Tālā" may correspond to a Sanskrit term meaning "palm tree" or may be a transliteration of a proper name embedded in the dhāraṇī tradition. The sense of the title as a dhāraṇī designation rather than a descriptive epithet is clear from context.
- The phrase rendered as "the meaning of being equal to what is unequal" translates འཇམ་མཐོན་པོ་འདྲ་བའི་ཆོས་ཀྱི་ཐོས་པ་, literally "equal-to-the-unequal," a well-attested epithet for buddha-qualities in Mahāyāna literature, pointing to the Buddha's incomparable yet universally equable nature.

The dhāraṇī name कण्चोक ताला has been rendered in phonetic transliteration as "Konchok Talala" since no standard Sanskrit reconstruction is established; it may represent a Tibetan phonetic rendering of a Sanskrit original, but this is uncertain.

- The question from Mañjuśrī about "the cause and condition of emptiness" uses a single compound that could mean either "the cause and condition" together or simply "cause" in a looser sense. The rendering "cause and condition" follows the natural reading of the Tibetan compound and the standard doctrinal pair *hetu-pratyaya*.

The brahmin "like a great sāla tree abiding in equanimity" is a somewhat unusual figure; the text seems to introduce a new interlocutor here. The identity of this brahmin is not specified in the passage, and this may be a named figure from the broader sūtra context not recoverable from the excerpt alone.

- The phrase rendered "the Sovereign King of All Phenomena" translates Chos thams cad kyi dbang phyug gi rgyal po, a bodhisattva name or epithet meaning literally "the sovereign lord of all phenomena." This appears to be a specific bodhisattva character in this sūtra context rather than a common appellative.

The expression "one who has an object of observation" translates dmigs pa can du 'gyur ro, meaning one who perceives or apprehends things as concrete referential objects — a technical implication that Śāradvatīputra, by failing to fit any category, would end up reified as a conceptual object. The doctrinal thrust is that Mañjuśrī is pressing Śāradvatīputra toward recognizing the ungraspability of his own status.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source text provided; the translation follows the Tibetan as given.

- The Tibetan name rendered throughout as "Dharmamati" is Chos kyi blo gros, literally "intellect of the Dharma" or "Dharma-intelligence." Dharmamati is the standard Sanskrit equivalent used in scholarship for this bodhisattva. The samādhi name dkon mchog ta la la sbyor ba mtha' yas pa has been rendered as "Endless Application to the Rare and Precious" — ta la la is an onomatopoeic Tibetan particle suggesting gentle swaying or flickering; the full term approximates a samādhi of ceaselessly and delicately applying oneself to the precious. This rendering is approximate and the precise doctrinal nuance of ta la la in this technical context may warrant attention.

- The phrase rendered "ten grounds that are difficult to approach" translates bsñen par dka' ba'i gnas bcu, literally "ten places that are difficult to approach." This is a standard list that closely parallels the ten powers (daśabala) of a buddha — the capacity to know what is a proper ground and what is not, knowledge of karma, and so forth. In this context the text presents them as something the newly mind-awakened bodhisattva "embraces" or "takes up" as an aspiration or a field of cultivation rather than as already-perfected attainments, which is doctrinally noteworthy. The near-identity with the standard ten powers list is intentional and significant in the text's argument about lineage.

- The phrase rendered "without breath" translates a term that literally means "without exhalation" or "without respiration." In the context of this contemplative list, it functions as a descriptor of phenomena as inert or lifeless, free from the animation of vital breath. The rendering "without breath" preserves this sense for a general listener.

The closing sentence states a paradox central to Yogācāra contemplative practice: genuine engagement with phenomena neither involves deliberate effortful striving nor its deliberate abandonment. This is a doctrinal refinement distinguishing the Yogācāra practitioner's mode from both forced cultivation and passive non-engagement.

- The phrase rendered "supremely born" translates a Tibetan term meaning literally "born as born" or "fully born," which in context refers to one who is genuinely and authentically born into the spiritual lineage through the sacred teachings. The rendering "supremely born" follows the doctrinal sense of one who has fully arisen within the noble scriptural tradition.

The repeated structural formula "applying oneself to them directly rather than depending on another" renders a technical phrase about self-reliance in practice at each stage, as distinct from reliance on external instruction, which is a mark of internalized realization.

- The passage lists ten grounds or stations pertaining to the bodhisattva of excellent

application framed in terms of the nature of sentient beings — boundless, immeasurable, uncountable, and so forth down to without intrinsic nature. These are somewhat unusual formulations and serve as objects of contemplative orientation rather than the standard ten bodhisattva grounds, so "grounds" here renders the term in the sense of "topics" or "bases correctly declared."

The phrase rendered as "not being distracted from this" translates a term indicating that the practitioner is not seized away or pulled off from this orientation; the sense is one of unwavering continuity of the superior intention.

- The phrase rendered as "ten streams of Dharma" translates a compound meaning something like "ten continua" or "ten streams" of Dharma proclamation. The Tibetan གཞི་བློ་གསལ་བཤད་པ་འབྲེལ་བཤད་ཀྱི་རྒྱུ་མཉན་པ་ literally means "ten streams of Dharma," here used in the sense of ten ongoing, flowing statements or declarations about phenomena.

The series of "superimposition" statements in the ten streams of Dharma presents genuine interpretive difficulty. The term "संश्लेषणं" (superimposition, Skt. *āropita* or *samāropa*) is used throughout; the passage describes a dialectical pattern in which each of a pair of opposed concepts is said to superimpose the other. The translation preserves this structural parallelism faithfully.

- The list of ten grounds for the regent bodhisattva contains nine explicit items as enumerated in the Tibetan, suggesting either a scribal omission of one item or an unusual counting convention in the source. This is a genuine textual uncertainty worth noting for a critical edition.
- The sixfold description of the earth-trembling follows a formulaic threefold intensification pattern for each of six modes of movement and sound, rendered here as best captures the liturgical rhythm for listening. The six modes in Tibetan use three movement terms and three sound or vibrational terms; the pairing of each with progressive intensifiers is a standard cosmological literary device in Avatamsaka-style sūtras.

The phrase rendered "clouds of divine powder" refers to fragrant powder or aromatic dust offered as homage, a conventional element of the celestial offering sequence in this literature.

- The closing verse ends mid-sequence without a concluding line; this is because the Tibetan passage itself ends mid-verse, clearly a deliberate cut at the boundary of the supplied text. The translation faithfully ends at the same point.

The phrase rendered "adorned with marks that are difficult to approach and see" translates ལྷན་པོར་བསྐྱེད་པའི་མཚན་ཅན་གྱིས་བཙུངས་པའི་སྒྲོམ་ཆེན་པོ།, where ལྷན་པོར་བསྐྱེད་པའི་ could also describe the marks as "hard to draw near" in the sense of inspiring awe or reverence; the rendering is intentionally ambiguous in the same way the Tibetan is.

The phrase བཤམ་པོ་ལྷན་པོ་ལྷན་པོ་ལྷན་པོ་ in the third verse refers to the qualities of Samantabhadra, the bodhisattva. Context makes this clearly a reference to the bodhisattva rather than to a generic quality of universal goodness.

- The phrase rendered "the broad and vast tongue" alludes to the classical mark of a great being whose tongue, when extended, can cover the entire face — a standard physical characteristic listed among the major marks of a buddha. The passage is deliberately evoking that image in the context of the omniscient power of speech.

The final stanza is grammatically incomplete as the Tibetan passage ends mid-construction, cutting off before the concluding refrain line. This is a continuity break in the supplied text, not a corruption; the missing line would be the standard refrain "one plants this mind in steadfast resolve for the sake of awakening."

- The phrase rendered "bliss and union belong to the bodhisattva" translates

安樂和合, literally "the ease-and-joining of the bodhisattva." The compound 安樂和合 can mean the pleasant practice or harmonious engagement of the bodhisattva path; the translation "bliss and union" captures both elements but the phrase admits of slightly different readings.

The line 此心是二心 is rendered as "this is described as twofold: the first-stage practitioner." The "twofold" likely refers to the twofold aspect of the initial mind-arousal described in the preceding lines (the aspiring mind and its expression in conduct), though the exact referent is not made explicit in this passage.

- The phrase rendered "born of the awakening mind" translates "thugs skyes pa'i byang chub sems dpa'," literally "bodhisattva born of [the awakening] mind," which may carry the nuance of being generated or sustained by bodhicitta rather than physical birth; the rendering follows the natural reading.

The compound "legs skyes mthar thug" in the omniscience stanza is somewhat elliptical; it has been read as referring to those who are supremely or ultimately well-born, coordinated with "grub pa" (the accomplished) and "rang byung" (the self-arisen), all as objects of reflection on omniscience.

The passage ends mid-thought, as this is a continuous text; the final lines are deliberately left open.

- The phrase rendered "measures the ocean's depth" is literally "by a single drop from a hair-tip one can take the measure of the water," a standard simile for the incommensurability of the bodhisattva-regent's qualities with ordinary reckoning; the point is that even the calculable vastness of atomized world-systems falls short of expressing the bodhisattva's wisdom.

The term translated "palace and retinue" refers to the royal-court imagery of the bodhisattva-regent who is about to receive the Dharma-king's empowerment and ascend to buddhahood; the whole passage draws on the metaphor of a crown prince assuming sovereignty.

The word "tālā" in the dhāraṇī name is left as a Sanskrit proper noun since it is part of a title; its precise referent in this context is uncertain but likely denotes the tāla-palm tree, a common symbol of indestructibility and height.

- The term rendered "bhlātkṣa" (Tibetan: shing blag sha) is a tree name that has not been identified with certainty; the Tibetan may be a phonetic rendering of a Sanskrit botanical name. It is paired here with the well-known śāla tree. The identity of the tree remains uncertain and a Sanskrit restoration is not confidently possible.

The gesture of the Blessed One extending his tongue is a classical buddhological sign authenticating a proclamation as true; it is one of the major marks of a great being and functions here as a solemn ratification of the statement that follows.

- The opening description of Mañjuśrī seated in a celestial mansion belongs with the preceding passage; the Tibetan continues seamlessly. The mansion lit by more than ten billion suns is described as Mañjuśrī's abode, consistent with the narrative flow.

Several of the śrāvaka names in the Tibetan correspond to well-known disciples under variant Tibetan spellings: འུགས་པ་མཆོག་ལྷ་མོ་ is rendered as Trisambha (a less common figure); འུགས་པ་པཎ་ཐ་ཀ་ as Panthaka (Cūḷapanthaka); འུགས་པ་སྤྲཱ་ག་ཏ་ as Svāgata; འུགས་པ་འཇལ་པ་ as Vāṣpa. The nun འུགས་པ་ཤྲྀ་སྤྲཱ་ལྷ་ is rendered Dhṛtaśīlā, though her Sanskrit name is not entirely certain from this spelling alone.

- The phrase "courageous progression" renders the Tibetan meditative absorption name

literally as "the samādhi of going forth with courage" — this likely corresponds to a named samādhi in Sanskrit sources, though the exact Sanskrit equivalent is not determinable from context alone.

The phrase "acceptance of the birthlessness of phenomena" renders the standard Tibetan for the doctrine of anutpattikadharmakṣānti, the patient acceptance or tolerance of the non-arising of phenomena, a key attainment on the bodhisattva path.

- The dhāraṇī name rendered "Ratnataḷa" translates the Tibetan dkon mchog ta la la, which appears to be a proper name combining "jewel" with what is likely a transliterated Sanskrit element; the exact Sanskrit reconstruction is uncertain.

The bodhisattva name rendered "Mahāsthāmaprāpta" (mthgy chen thob) is the standard identification of this figure in Mahāyāna literature. The name "Remover of Evil Destinies" (ngan song spong) and several others in the list are epithets translated directly from the Tibetan, as no standard Sanskrit equivalents are recoverable from context alone.

- The repeated exclamation "Alalā — the Dharma" is a transliteration of a Sanskrit exclamation of wonder or joy, likely "aho dharma" or a similar expressive phrase rendered phonetically in Tibetan. Its precise Sanskrit form is uncertain; it functions as a spontaneous utterance of acclaim for the Dharma and is rendered as a phonetic approximation here. The repetition two and three times is a standard sūtra device for solemn emphasis.

The term "Ratnatālā" for the dhāraṇī name is retained as a Sanskrit proper noun consistent with the preceding passage's rendering.

- The exchange between Śāradvatīputra and Mañjuśrī follows a catechetical pattern in which Mañjuśrī answers each question about "how long" with a referent that is without fixed duration or entry-point, and Śāradvatīputra simply echoes the answer back, affirming it. This is a standard dialectical device illustrating the ineffable depth of the Dharma-enumeration being discussed; the repetitive structure is deliberate and has been preserved.

The phrase rendered "even to the extent of one moment of displeasure" translates a condensed Tibetan idiom meaning a single brief thought of unfriendliness; the phrasing "far removed from rebirth as a human being" reflects the classical soteriological scale, in which human rebirth is already rare and precious, and thus being far from it signals a dire karmic trajectory.

- The names of the hell-realms are translated interpretively from Tibetan descriptive terms rather than from established canonical Sanskrit equivalents. The list may correspond to a known Sanskrit source, but without that source at hand the names are rendered according to their literal Tibetan meanings. A specialist in the relevant sūtra tradition may wish to verify these against a Sanskrit or Chinese parallel.

The phrase rendered "those undeluded persons" is the same term used throughout this passage for those who reject the sūtra — the irony appears intentional in the original, designating them sarcastically as the "undeluded" while describing their grievous downfall.

- The phrase rendered "may fully consume" translates yongs su spyad pa, meaning to use up or exhaust the merit of a gift — the doctrinal point is that the transgressor forfeits the full ripening of their meritorious giving, which I do not allow them to enjoy even in the smallest measure. The Blessed One's declaration is that even the most trivial gift offered in faith cannot be fully enjoyed by such a person.

The comparison between the five acts of immediate retribution and abandoning the Dharma is a standard doctrinal escalation: the ānantarya-karmas ordinarily lead to immediate rebirth in hell without interval, yet the text insists that abandoning the Dharma surpasses even these in gravity, since those who commit the five acts can still eventually attain liberation, whereas the

Dharma-abandoner is cut off from all buddha-qualities entirely. This is a significant and consequential doctrinal claim preserved faithfully from the source.

- The phrase rendered "bears no responsibility for that" translates a Tibetan idiom meaning literally "the Tathāgata has not answered back" or "the Tathāgata has not repaid that," indicating that the Tathāgata is not the causal agent responsible for beings' suffering from their karma. The doctrinal point is that karma is self-determining; the Buddha teaches the path but does not produce the suffering that results from beings' own actions. The phrasing "bears no responsibility" captures this theological sense without implying moral culpability.

The final sentence breaks off mid-discourse at the fascicle boundary; this is normal for Tibetan canonical texts divided into fascicles.

- The phrase rendered "a finding that is no finding at all" translates a Tibetan idiomatic construction meaning that those sentient beings have gained something that amounts to a terrible loss — they have "found" suffering rather than the genuine attainment of the Dharma.

The dhāraṇī called "of the precious tāla tree" renders Dkon mchog ta la la'i gzungs. The tāla tree (Sanskrit tāla) is the palmyra palm, a common Indian symbol of lofty stature; the epithet "precious" marks this as a specific named dhāraṇī rather than a generic description.

The verse is metrically tight in the original and the rendering preserves its four-line structure, though the appositive epithets in the first two lines are dense and interpretive choices have been made for sense and flow.

- The phrase rendered "the last of the five hundred years" refers to the traditional doctrine of the five successive five-hundred-year periods following the Buddha's parinirvāṇa, the last being the age of Dharma's decline. This is a standard eschatological formula in Mahāyāna sūtra literature.

The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end, as this is the continuation prompt boundary; no text has been omitted or altered.

- The epithet translated as "the Stacked Essence, the Radiance of Excellence, the Center of Innumerable Inconceivable Rays of Light" renders a proper name of a previous Tathāgata: Tibetan ye shes thogs pa med pa brtsegs pa'i snying po 'od zer bzang po bsam gyis mi khyab pa'i 'od zer du ma'i lte ba rgyas pa. This is a complex compound proper name for a former buddha from whom Śākyamuni heard the teaching in a previous life. The rendering is a literal translation of the name's components rather than a reconstructed Sanskrit equivalent, as no Sanskrit original is available for verification.

The sixfold trembling formula at the close is a standard canonical description found across many Mahāyāna sūtras; the six modes are rendered in their traditional triadic pattern of simple, intensive, and all-pervasive action.

- The phrase rendered "compendium of Dharma" translates chos kyi nam grangs, which literally means "categories" or "synonyms" of Dharma but functions here as a title-epithet for the sūtra itself. In sūtra literature this compound regularly designates the text as a whole, so "compendium of Dharma" conveys the sense adequately for a listening audience.

The number "nine hundred and twenty-two million bodhisattvas" renders bye ba phrag dgu bcu rtsa gnyis, literally "ninety-two times ten million," which equals 920,000,000 in standard Indic numerical reckoning.

- The passage is drawn from a verse section of the Gaṇḍavyūha or a related Buddhāvataṃsaka text. The line "ॐ श्री नमो भगवते वासुदेवाय" refers to a bodhisattva character whose name combines "Śrī" (श्री), "Noble" (नमो), and "Excellent" (भगवते), rendered here as "Śrī of Noble Excellence." This is a proper epithet-name of a bodhisattva interlocutor in the exchange; the Tibetan does not give a distinct Sanskrit name beyond this compound, and so it is rendered

descriptively throughout.

The phrase "འདྲེང་སྒྲོང་ཆེན་པོ་" in the line on faith literally means "those who have become lords or masters of men," which in this context idiomatically refers to bodhisattvas who, through faith, become sovereign over themselves; rendered accordingly.

- The phrase rendered "what to engage and what not to engage" translates a compressed Tibetan idiom for appropriate and inappropriate conduct or application; the context of "evenness" suggests equanimity with regard to these distinctions at the level of the bodhisattva lineage, though some commentators read this as abandoning discriminations about what to take up and what to set aside on the path.

The term rendered "great sages" translates drang srong chen po, literally "great ṛṣis," which in a Mahāyāna context typically refers to the great bodhisattvas or to the buddhas themselves.

- The term rendered "acceptance of non-arising" is the standard Mahāyāna technical term for the bodhisattva's realization that phenomena have no intrinsic arising, Sanskrit anutpattikadharmakṣānti, here abbreviated in the Tibetan to mi skye bzod pa. "Spiritual nourishment" renders rtun pa dam pa mchog, literally "supreme excellent sustenance," a somewhat unusual metaphor for the inner support or nourishment that sustains bodhisattva practice; no single English technical term is fully settled for this, but "spiritual nourishment" captures the sense well. "Higher knowledge" throughout renders mngon shes, Sanskrit abhijñā, the supranormal cognitive powers cultivated on the bodhisattva path.

- The phrase rendered "their body is the gnosis of qualities and dharmatā" reflects the Tibetan "yon tan chos nyid ye shes lus," a compressed construction meaning that their very body consists of gnosis that is the dharmatā of qualities, a standard Mahāyāna formulation pointing toward the dharmakāya understood as gnosis-body.

The line "the power of the Three Jewels rises to the highest excellence" renders "dkon mchog mthu yang dam pa mchog tu 'gyur," where dkon mchog ("rare and supreme") is the standard Tibetan for the Three Jewels; the sense is that the collective power of buddha, Dharma, and Saṅgha is supremely enhanced.

The "supreme jewel of hard vajra" simile is structurally parallel to the qualities-water simile that follows it; the point is that just as a vajra-gem keeps ocean jewels neither depleting nor inflating, so the boundless quality-stream of these beings maintains the Dharma in fields otherwise lacking it.

- The phrase rendered "great serpents" and "mighty sea-serpents" translates རྩྱུ་མཆོག་ཆེན་པོ་ and རྩྱུ་མཆོག་ཆེན་པོ་ respectively. རྩྱུ་མཆོག་ is a term for a type of coiled or hooded serpent-being and རྩྱུ་མཆོག་ཆེན་པོ་ denotes a great belly-gliding serpent, both understood as supernatural serpentine beings within the nāga class or adjacent categories; the translation renders them descriptively since precise Sanskrit equivalents are uncertain.

The final verse is incomplete in the source passage as given, ending mid-sentence; the translation reflects this as-is.

- The phrase rendered "vehicle of conditions" translates the Tibetan term for the pratyekabuddha vehicle, literally "the vehicle of conditions," which is an unusual but textually attested way of referring to the pratyekabuddha path, emphasizing that pratyekabuddhas awaken through contemplation of dependent origination and its conditions without relying on a teacher's direct instruction.

The passage ends mid-stanza with "impermanence and suffering" and continues in the next passage; no completion has been supplied.

- The phrase rendered "through every gate of liberation" translates a construction that appears twice in close succession with slight syntactic variation; the repetition is original and is

preserved in the translation.

The term *kalavinka* refers to a bird famed in Indian tradition for its exceptionally melodious voice; it is often left untranslated in Buddhist texts but here a brief gloss would not flow naturally in TTS, so the name is left as is.

The "ten practices of conduct" likely refers to the tenfold path of virtuous action or a standard enumeration found in Mahāyāna texts; the precise referent may vary by commentarial tradition.

- The term rendered "flight-enabling mantras" translates a compound literally meaning "mantras that serve as a basis for flying or levitation," a known class of mantra practice in both Buddhist and non-Buddhist Indian traditions.

The phrase "thirty-fold group of non-Buddhists" refers to a specific enumeration of thirty non-Buddhist philosophical schools, a standard list in Indo-Tibetan doxographical literature.

"Words of analysis and letters" renders a compound involving syllabic or grammatical analysis, possibly referring to a tradition of grammatical or Mīmāṃsā-style exegesis.

The "kinnaras" mentioned alongside *gandharvas* appear as "grulbum" in the Tibetan, a standard Tibetan rendering of the Sanskrit *kinnara*, a class of semi-divine celestial musicians.

- The final half-verse is incomplete in the supplied passage; the translation ends where the Tibetan breaks off. The phrase rendered "lamps of grass, wood, reeds, and lac" translates a list that includes the term for a plant-derived wax or lac-light source alongside the more common fuel sources; the exact botanical referent is uncertain but does not affect the doctrinal sense. The verse "May joy increase and may I become self-arisen" reflects the aspiration to become a naturally arisen, self-originated buddha, a recognized Mahāyāna formulation for *bodhicitta* directed toward spontaneous, unborn buddhahood.

- The phrase rendered "the four māras" refers to the standard fourfold classification: the *māra* of the afflictions, the *māra* of the aggregates, the *māra* of death, and the *Māra* who is a deva. "Self-arisen" in the line about pure moral discipline translates *rang byung*, which in this context likely echoes an aspiration for an innately or spontaneously arisen quality of virtue rather than a reference to a specific doctrinal category; the precise nuance is contextually ambiguous but the rendering is defensible. "Utterly free of burning anguish" for *yongs su gdung med* renders the image of fire-like torment that moral transgression causes, a standard simile in this literature.

- The phrase rendered "elemental spirits, planets" translates "*byung po gza*" — elemental spirits and planetary influences — understood in the traditional Buddhist cosmological context as harmful non-human forces and malign astral influences. The combination is standard in Mahāyāna sūtra literature listing types of fear.

The term rendered "great seers" translates "*drang srong che*," literally "great ṛṣis," a standard epithet used in this literature both for buddhas and for great ascetics; context here suggests it refers to the buddhas and great teachers receiving offerings.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source; the translation reflects this and stops accordingly.

- The final line breaks off mid-sentence in the source passage, describing weapons raining down as part of a continuing description of the tactile-purification ray of light. The translation preserves this truncation faithfully, as the passage ends there in the supplied text.

The phrase rendered "adorning stūpas with images of bodies and paintings" translates a compound referring to sculptural images and painted figures used to decorate stūpas; the rendering follows the natural doctrinal sense of the dedicatory act that produces the

corresponding ray of light.

- The phrase rendered "servant-like children of the buddhas" translates "བོད་པ་ལྟ་བུ་ཆོས་ལུགས་ཀྱི་བླ་མ་གྱི་མཉམ་པ་ལྟ་བུ་བྱ་བ་ལྟ་བུ་," where "བྱ་བ་ལྟ་བུ་" literally means a foot-attendant or menial servant. The exact force here is slightly ambiguous: it could mean bodhisattvas who serve humbly, or it could be an honorific form of address. The rendering chosen preserves the literal image while the passage appears to continue beyond this excerpt.

The line "བོད་པ་ལྟ་བུ་ཆོས་ལུགས་ཀྱི་བླ་མ་གྱི་མཉམ་པ་ལྟ་བུ་བྱ་བ་ལྟ་བུ་" is rendered "abide within those samādhis as samādhis themselves," reflecting the paradoxical phrasing where the repeated term suggests both entering samādhi and transcending the ordinary notion of samādhi as an object of abiding.

- The passage describes a complex samādhi-display in which bodhisattvas simultaneously enter meditative equipoise in one direction and arise to make offerings in another, cycling through all ten directions. The structural parallelism of entering through one sense gateway and arising through the paired sense-object gateway (eye/form, ear/sound, nose/scent, tongue/taste, body/touch, mind/phenomena) is doctrinal and is rendered consistently throughout. The phrase rendered "without agent" for "byed pa med pa" (literally "without a maker/doer") in the emptiness refrains refers to the absence of any inherent agent producing the sense organ, a standard Madhyamaka formula; "without agent" preserves this technical nuance while remaining audible.

- The phrase rendered "one in training and one beyond training" refers to the standard Abhidharma distinction between those still on the trainable path (śaikṣa, those from stream-entry through the path of arhatship) and those beyond training (aśaikṣa, arhats). The pairing appears as a single compound in the Tibetan.

The term rendered "elemental spirit" translates a word meaning a class of spirit or being often associated with the elements; the precise identification in this cosmological catalogue is uncertain, but "elemental spirit" follows the commentarial tradition's reading of these as a broad category of such beings.

- The figure translated as "Resounding" is a goddess of the ocean whose name in Tibetan means literally "possessing sound or resonance." The Tumburu gandharva is a well-known celestial musician in Buddhist and Hindu cosmology; "wife of Tumburu" follows the text directly. The elephant Airāvaṇa is Indra's mythic mount in Indian tradition; "son of the earth-guardian" renders the Tibetan epithet literally and may refer to a genealogical epithet in the source tradition whose exact Sanskrit correlate is not fully certain here. The final image of Rāhu reaching only to the navel of the ocean describes his cosmic stature in mythological terms, setting up an implicit contrast with the greater powers of those trained in wisdom.

- The phrase rendered "the Light of the World, the supreme vanquisher of māras" translates the Tibetan epithets for the Buddha: "lamp of the world, utterly subjugating māras," here appearing as a rhetorical contrast with Rāhu at the opening of the passage.

The "lord of the asuras" throughout translates the Tibetan expression for the chief asura king; it refers to Vemacitrin in the traditional cosmological context of the divine war narrative.

The phrase "allied force" in "refuge and allied force" renders a military metaphor in the Tibetan literally, as it plays on the battle imagery of the drum episode.

- The "ten masteries" refers to the ten sovereignties or vaśitās, a standard Mahāyāna list of powers fully perfected by bodhisattvas at an advanced stage, including mastery over life, mind, necessities, karma, rebirth, aspiration, miraculous powers, gnosis, Dharma, and phenomena.

The divine realms listed — Nirmāṇarati, Tuṣita, Yāma, the Thirty-Three, and the realm of sovereignty — follow the standard cosmological schema of the desire-realm heavens. The

"realm of sovereignty" renders "dbang sgyur gnas," the heaven of the gods who exercise control over others' emanations, i.e., Paranirmitavaśavartin. The "realm of guardians" renders "skyong ba'i gnas," the heaven of the Four Great Kings. The "secret realm" and "realm of human beings" as listed here are somewhat unusual placements within this cosmological enumeration and may reflect a particular textual tradition; no emendation has been made.

- The term rendered "realm of Māra's sovereign" translates the Tibetan for the realm of the god who wields sovereignty over others, a realm in the desire realm above Nirmāṇarati, identified in standard Abhidharma cosmology with Paranirmitavaśavartin, the sixth heaven of the desire realm. The text uses "dBang sgyur gnas" throughout and this rendering is applied consistently.

"Mici" is a transcription of the Tibetan mi ci, a conventional name for a continent or realm appearing in the sequence of cosmological locations in this text. Its Sanskrit equivalent is uncertain and is left as a proper name.

The flower and plant names varṣa, mālīkā, campā, kurantaka, atimuktaka, and tagara and tamāla are Sanskrit botanical names transliterated from the Tibetan phonetic renderings; their identification is standard in Buddhist cosmological and poetic literature.

"Axle-trees" renders gnyā shing, which refers to the axle or yoke-pole of a cart or chariot, used here as a measure of the size of raindrops, a common Indian literary hyperbole for torrential rain.

- The name Śrī Bhadra renders སྐྱེལ་ལྷ་མོ་ in the verse passage. This compound, meaning "glorious goodness" or "splendid excellence," appears to be a name or epithet of the bodhisattva being honored by the buddhas of the ten directions. The identity is context-dependent and may refer to a specific figure named elsewhere in the larger sūtra.

The phrase འཇིགས་མེད་ཀྱི་ཐུགས་ཀྱི་འཁོར་ལོ་, literally "the vehicle of conditions," is a traditional epithet for the pratyekabuddha vehicle, referring to those who awaken by contemplating dependent origination without a teacher; the translation makes this explicit by the apposition.

- The final line is a colophon fragment, cut off mid-phrase in the source; the translation renders what is present and closes the title as it stands. "Tāla tree" renders ta la la, which refers to the palmyra or tāla palm, a standard symbol of great height and nobility in Indian Buddhist literature — here appearing as part of the dhāraṇī's full title.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.